1 Introduction: How, When and Where

Importance of Dates in History:

1. **Traditional Historical Focus on Dates:**
   - History was once synonymous with dates like battles, coronations, and events related to rulers.
   - *Example*: The dates of Warren Hastings' appointment as the first Governor-General (1773) and Lord Mountbatten's tenure as the last Viceroy (1947).
2. **Shifting Perspective:**
   - Modern historians focus less on specific dates and more on the processes, causes, and impacts of events.
   - *Example*: Instead of pinpointing when tea was introduced, historians study how it became popular over time.

Periodisation of Indian History:

1. **James Mill's Division (1817):**
   - Indian history was divided into three periods: Hindu, Muslim, and British.
   - Mill viewed British rule as progressive and civilising, while characterising pre-British India as "uncivilised."
2. **Modern Indian Periodisation:**

   Indian history is classified into:
   - **Ancient:** Early development of civilisation and culture.
   - **Medieval:** Growth of kingdoms and empires but viewed as lacking "modern" traits.
   - **Modern:** Associated with colonialism rather than modernity, as British rule hindered liberty, equality, and progress.

What is Colonialism?

Colonialism is the subjugation of one country by another, leading to political, economic, social, and cultural changes.

Impact of British Rule on India:

- Controlled economy by introducing cash crops for export.
- Changed societal values, customs, and governance systems.
- Preserved their dominance through administrative and legal structures.

Historical Sources:

1. **Official Records:**
   - British administration documented every decision, plan, and policy.
   - Records were stored in dedicated archives and institutions like the National Archives in New Delhi.
2. **Surveys:**
   - Included revenue surveys, census operations, and zoological, botanical, and archaeological surveys.
   - Helped gather detailed information about India's population, land, and resources.
3. **Unofficial Records:**
   - Diaries, autobiographies, newspapers, and literary works (novels, poems) provide personal insights and alternative perspectives.
4. **Limitations of Official Sources:**
   - Focused on administrative perspectives and ignored the lives of common people, tribal communities, and

marginalised groups.

Issues in Writing History:

1. **Whose Perspective Matters?**
   - History written by colonisers often reflects their biases.
   - *Example:* British accounts focus on their rulers rather than local leaders or the common population.
2. **Representation of Periods:**
   - Religion-based classifications like 'Hindu' or 'Muslim' periods overlook diversity & co-existence in those eras.
   - Need for unbiased, inclusive narratives.

Quick Facts:

- **First British Map of India:** Created by James Rennel in 1782.
- **Governor-General System:** Introduced in 1773, starting with Warren Hastings.
- **Census Operations:** Held every 10 years under British rule to record population demographics.
- **Colonial Surveys:** Included topographical, revenue, and botanical data collection.

1. Which goddess was a representation of British authority in India?
   (a) Athena (b) Britannia
   (c) Elizabeth (d) Victoria
2. In which city is the National Museum of India situated?
   (a) Kolkata (b) Delhi
   (c) Shimla (d) Madras
3. Which country was James Mill, the author of "A History of British India," associated with?
   (a) England (b) Scotland
   (c) New Zealand (d) Switzerland
4. Who created the first map of Hindustan in 1782?
   (a) James Rennell (b) Thomas Roe
   (c) Robert Clive (d) William Bentinck
5. What does the advertisement's background portray?
   (a) A tea plantation
   (b) A British castle
   (c) The outer wall of an Indian palace
   (d) A European garden
6. Why did the British start conducting surveys in India?
   (a) To study rural topography
   (b) To expand revenue collection
   (c) For administrative mapping
   (d) To establish judiciary
7. Who was the last Viceroy of India?
   (a) Lord Curzon (b) Lord Wavell
   (c) Lord Mountbatten (d) Lord Irwin
8. In which year and city was the National Archives of India initially established, and later transferred to Delhi in 1911?
   (a) 1891, Calcutta (b) 1911, Delhi
   (c) 1891, Bombay (d) 1920, Calcutta
9. Which was the first tea brand marketed by the East India Company?
   (a) Tata Gold (b) Tez
   (c) Black Leaf Tea (d) Red Label
10. Who held the position of the first Governor-General of India?
    (a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Warren Hastings
    (c) Lord Canning (d) Robert Clive
11. According to James Mill, which governance could uplift Indian society?
    (a) Hindu (b) French
    (c) Muslim (d) British
12. Who wrote the book titled "A History of British India"?
    (a) John Henry (b) Clive Loyd
    (c) Nicholas Louis (d) James Mill
13. What does 'Britannia' symbolize in the picture given in the NCERT book?
    (a) The heritage of Indian culture
    (b) The rule of Indian monarchy
    (c) British supremacy and power
    (d) The leadership of Indian freedom fighters
14. Where are the National Museum and National Archives of India located?
    (a) Bengaluru (b) Madras
    (c) Kolkata (d) New Delhi

15. James Mill categorized which societies as less developed?
(a) European (b) American
(c) Asian (d) African

16. What does the term 'Calligrapher' refer to?
(a) A specialist in designing letters beautifully
(b) A specialist in oratory
(c) A specialist in painting
(d) A specialist in playing instruments

17. How is imperialism best described?
(a) A system of traditional governance
(b) A method of colonization
(c) A form of political dominance
(d) A technical system

18. Which activity was most valued by the colonial government?
(a) Conducting surveys
(b) Organizing meetings
(c) Gathering census data
(d) Holding discussions

19. Which organization was created in the 1920s to preserve important documents?
(a) Settlements
(b) National Archives of India
(c) Victoria Memorial
(d) Parliamentary House

20. During the construction of which city were the National Museum and National Archives established near the Viceregal Palace?
(a) Kerala (b) Kolkata
(c) Mumbai (d) Delhi

21. Which of the following best describes James Mill?
(a) A historian and writer
(b) A political philosopher
(c) An economist
(d) All of these

22. What is history primarily associated with?
(a) Important dates and events
(b) Geographical places
(c) Only past wars
(d) Myths and legends

23. In which year did Tipu Sultan ascend to the throne of Mysore?
(a) 1769 (b) 1770
(c) 1782 (d) 1772

24. During the 18th century, who copied official British documents?
(a) Military personnel (b) Journalists
(c) Writers (d) Calligraphists

25. What is the main focus of history when studying the past?
(a) How things evolved
(b) How things changed
(c) How things started
(d) How things ended

26. What serves as a crucial source of knowledge about the dates of British administration?
(a) Official records (b) Brutality
(c) Rule (d) Judiciary

27. How often is the Census conducted in India?
(a) Every 5 years (b) Every 20 years
(c) Every 10 years (d) Every 15 years

28. What was the primary reason for the British coming to India?
(a) To establish trade (b) Religious reform
(c) Military conquest (d) Spread Christianity

29. Which event can be clearly identified with a specific date?
(a) The assassination of Mahatma Gandhi
(b) The launch of the Civil Disobedience Movement
(c) The start of British rule in India
(d) The beginning of Mughal rule in India

MCQ Answer

1-b	2-b	3-b	4-a	5-c
6-a	7-c	8-a	9-c	10-b
11-d	12-d	13-c	14-d	15-c
16-a	17-c	18-a	19-b	20-d
21-d	22-a	23-c	24-d	25-b
26-a	27-c	28-a	29-a	

2 From Trade to Territory: The Company Establishes Power

Aurangzeb and the Decline of the Mughal Empire:

- Aurangzeb was the last powerful Mughal ruler, controlling vast territories in India.
- After his death in 1707, Mughal governors (subadars) and big zamindars asserted authority, forming regional kingdoms.
- Delhi could no longer function as an effective centre of power.
- By the mid-18th century, the British, initially a small trading company, began expanding their influence.

The English East India Company:

1. **Formation and Early Activities**
   - Established in 1600 by a Royal Charter from Queen Elizabeth I, granting exclusive rights to trade with the East.
   - The Company bought goods like cotton, silk, spices, and sold them at high profits in Europe.
   - Rivalry with other European powers like the Portuguese, Dutch, and French created intense competition.
2. **Trade in Bengal**

Early Establishments:

- The first English factory in Bengal was set up on the banks of the Hugli River in 1651.
- By 1696, the Company began fortifying its settlements.
- Aurangzeb issued a farman granting duty-free trade, which the Company abused for private gains.

Conflicts with the Bengal Nawabs:

- Nawabs like Murshid Quli Khan, Alivardi Khan, and Siraj-ud-Daulah opposed the Company's growing influence.
- The Company refused to pay taxes, causing huge revenue losses to Bengal and leading to conflicts.

European East India Companies:

Discovery of the Sea Route to India: Vasco da Gama, a Portuguese explorer, discovered the sea route to India in 1498, opening opportunities for European trade with India.

Key European Trading Companies:

- **Portuguese East India Company:** Established in 1498, marking the beginning of European trading dominance in India.
- **English East India Company:** Formed in 1600, it became the most influential foreign trading entity in India.
- **Dutch East India Company:** Founded in 1602, it competed with other European powers for control of Indian trade routes.
- **French East India Company:** Established in 1664, it aimed to expand French influence in India but was overshadowed by the English East India Company.

The Battle of Plassey (1757):

- **Cause:** Siraj-ud-Daulah opposed British interference and fortifications.
- **Outcome:**
  - ⇒ Robert Clive led the British forces and secured victory through the betrayal of Mir Jafar.
  - ⇒ The British gained control of Bengal.
- **Significance:** Marked the Company's first major territorial victory in India.

The Battle of Buxar (1764):

- **Participants:** British (led by Hector Munro) vs. Mir Qasim (Nawab of Bengal), Shuja-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Awadh), and Shah Alam II (Mughal Emperor).
- **Outcome:** The British defeated the coalition, securing Diwani rights (revenue collection) for Bengal, Bihar, and Odisha.

Expansion of British Rule:

1. **Subsidiary Alliance System:**
   - Introduced by **Lord Wellesley**, requiring Indian rulers to:
     - ⇒ Maintain British troops at their expense.
     - ⇒ Give up territory if they failed to pay.
   - States like Awadh and Hyderabad were forced into alliances.
2. **Doctrine of Lapse:**
   - Introduced by **Lord Dalhousie** (1848–1856).
   - Allowed annexation of states where rulers died without a male heir.
   - **States annexed:** Satara (1848), Sambalpur (1850), Udaipur (1852), Nagpur (1853), Jhansi (1854), and Awadh (1856).

Resistance and Notable Figures:

1. **Tipu Sultan – The Tiger of Mysore:**
   - Ruled Mysore from 1782–1799, modernised the army, and allied with the French.
   - Fought **four wars** with the British. **Tipu was killed** in the **Battle of Srirangapatnam (1799)**, ending Mysore's resistance.

Anglo-Mysore Wars:

- **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–1769):** Fought in Mysore between Hyder Ali and the British East India Company, it ended with the Treaty of Madras (1769), restoring territories.
- **Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780–1784):** Fought in Mysore and the Carnatic region between Tipu Sultan & Hyder Ali and the British, it concluded with the Treaty of Mangalore (1784), retaining Mysore's independence.
- **Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790–1792):** Fought in Mysore and nearby regions between Tipu Sultan and the British, Marathas, and the Nizam of Hyderabad, it ended with the Treaty of Seringapatam (1792), with Mysore losing half its territory.
- **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1798–1799):** Fought in Srirangapatnam between Tipu Sultan and the British, Marathas, and the Nizam of Hyderabad, it led to Tipu Sultan's death and Mysore's annexation.

2. **The Marathas:**

Fought three wars with the British:

- **First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782):** Ended with no decisive victory.
- **Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–1805):** British gained territories like Delhi and Agra.
- **Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1819):** British ended Maratha dominance.

Claim to Paramountcy:

Under Lord Hastings (1813–1823), the British expanded their territorial control by establishing themselves as the supreme power in India.

Notable Nawabs of Bengal:

The Nawabs of Bengal played a pivotal role in shaping the region's history during the 18th century. Here are the prominent rulers:

1. **Murshid Quli Khan (1717–1727):**
   - The first Nawab of Bengal, he laid the foundation for a semi-independent Bengal.
   - Known for efficient administration and revenue reforms.

2. **Alivardi Khan (1740–1756):**
   - Consolidated Bengal's power and protected the region from invasions.
   - Defended Bengal against repeated attacks by the Marathas.
3. **Siraj-ud-Daulah (1756–1757):**
   - The last independent Nawab of Bengal, remembered for his opposition to British interference.
   - Fought against the British East India Company in the **Battle of Plassey (1757)** but was betrayed by Mir Jafar and others.
4. **Mir Jafar (1757–1760):**
   - Installed as a puppet Nawab by the British after the Battle of Plassey.
   - His inability to govern effectively led to his replacement by Mir Qasim.
5. **Mir Qasim (1760–1764):**
   - Known for attempting to regain Bengal's independence from British control.
   - Defeated in the **Battle of Buxar (1764)**, which resulted in British supremacy in Bengal and northern India.

Administration Under British Rule:

1. **Warren Hastings' Reforms:**

Judicial Changes:
- Established criminal courts (Faujdari Adalat) and civil courts (Diwani Adalat).
- Introduced Supreme Court (1773) and Sadar Nizamat Adalat for appeals.
- Codified Hindu and Muslim laws for uniformity.

Revenue Collection:
- Collectors were appointed to collect taxes and maintain law and order.

2. **The Company Army:**
   - Initially recruited sepoys (sipahis) from rural areas.
   - Modernised with muskets and matchlocks by the 1820s.
   - European-style drills and discipline often clashed with caste and community sentiments, leading to discontent.

Battles of Panipat:

- **First Battle of Panipat (1526):** Fought between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi, it marked the beginning of the Mughal Empire in India.
- **Second Battle of Panipat (1556):** Fought between Akbar's forces led by Bairam Khan and Hemu, it re-established Mughal rule in India.
- **Third Battle of Panipat (1761):** Fought between the Marathas and Ahmad Shah Abdali, it ended with a decisive victory for Abdali and a significant loss for the Marathas.

1. Where did the East India Company first arrive in India?
   (a) Hugli in 1613 (b) 1610 at Masulipatnam
   (c) 1609 at Calcutta (d) 1608 at Surat
2. Why did the British annex Awadh (Lucknow) in 1856?
   (a) Doctrine of Lapse
   (b) Subsidiary Alliance
   (c) Misgovernance by Nawab Wajid Ali Shah
   (d) Non-payment of revenue
3. In which year did Aurangzeb pass away?
   (a) 1710 (b) 1707
   (c) 1705 (d) 1711
4. Who preceded Tipu Sultan as the ruler of Mysore?
   (a) Mir Jafar (b) Haider Ali
   (c) Aslam II (d) Lord Canning
5. Who was the last ruler of the Mughal empire?
   (a) Shah Alam II (b) Akbar II
   (c) Bahadur Shah Zafar (d) Aurangzeb
6. Where did Rani Channamma revolt against the British?
   (a) Kitoor (b) Kanpur
   (c) Lahore (d) Mangalore

7. In which year did the First British-Afghan War begin?
(a) 1838 (b) 1850
(c) 1835 (d) 1822

8. Who was the father of Akbar the Great?
(a) Babur (b) Sher Shah
(c) Haider Ali (d) Humayun

9. Along which river did the British establish their first English factory in 1651?
(a) Kaveri (b) Hugli
(c) Yamuna (d) Narmada

10. Which monarch granted the East India Company a charter to trade with India in the early 1600s?
(a) Queen Victoria (b) Queen Elizabeth I
(c) King George V (d) Queen Elizabeth II

11. Who was defeated by the British in the Battle of Buxar?
(a) Mir Qasim (b) Sirajuddaulah
(c) Mir Jafar (d) Alivardi Khan

12. Where was Fort William, a fortified British factory, established in India?
(a) Gujarat (b) Delhi
(c) Madras (d) Calcutta

13. Which Nawab of Bengal opposed the British policy of duty-free trade?
(a) Murshid Quli Khan (b) Siraj-ud-Daulah
(c) Mir Qasim (d) Mir Jafar

14. Which territory was annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse in 1848?
(a) Kanpur (b) Satara
(c) Gwalior (d) Poona

15. Who was the first person to discover the sea route to India?
(a) Vasco da Gama (b) James Cook
(c) Thomas Cook (d) Columbus

16. Who was the Nawab of Bengal during the late 1690s?
(a) Murshid Quli Khan (b) Shujauddaulah
(c) Khuda Baksh (d) Akbar II

17. Who arrested the last Mughal ruler, Bahadur Shah Zafar?
(a) Lord Dalhousie (b) General Hugh Rose
(c) Captain Hodson (d) Sir John Lawrence

18. When did Alivardi Khan die?
(a) 1777 (b) 1756
(c) 1791 (d) 1780

19. After whose death did the Bengal Nawabs assert their autonomy and power?
(a) Jahangir (b) Akbar
(c) Bahadur Shah (d) Aurangzeb

20. After the Battle of Buxar, who did the British appoint in Indian states to maintain control?
(a) Ministers (b) Residents
(c) Nawabs (d) Financers

21. On which date was the Battle of Plassey fought between the Nawab of Bengal and the British?
(a) 23rd May 1757 (b) 23rd June 1757
(c) 23rd July 1757 (d) 23rd August 1757

22. The Battle of Buxar was fought in which year?
(a) 1764 (b) 1765
(c) 1767 (d) 1769

23. Which product from India had a large market in Europe when European traders began trade in the country?
(a) Pepper (b) Cotton
(c) Wheat (d) Timber

24. During which period was Richard Wellesley the Governor-General of Bengal?
(a) 1798-1805 (b) 1766-1770
(c) 1790-95 (d) 1775-1780

25. When was the French East India Company established?
(a) 1644 (b) 1664
(c) 1684 (d) 1702

26. How many Anglo-Mysore Wars were fought between Mysore and the British?
(a) Two (b) Three
(c) Four (d) Five

27. Which of the following statements are correct?
I. The Battle of Buxar occurred in 1764 AD.
II. The Battle of Plassey took place in 1757 AD.
III. The Third Battle of Panipat took place in 1761 AD.
IV. The First Anglo-Mysore War took place in 1766 AD.
V. The Jallianwala Bagh massacre occurred in Amritsar, 1919.
VI. The Third Anglo-Mysore War occurred during the period 1790-92.
(a) I II and V (b) I, III, V & VI
(c) III, IV and VI (d) All of these

28. Which river flows through Kolkata?
(a) Yamuna (b) Hugli
(c) Swarnaprabha (d) Mahi

29. Where was the first French factory in India established in 1668?
(a) Ahmedabad (b) Porbandar
(c) Surat (d) Madras

30. Who introduced the Doctrine of Lapse in India?
(a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Lord Canning
(c) Lord Clive (d) Lord Curzon

31. Who was the last powerful Mughal emperor in India?
(a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

32. What was the capital of Tipu Sultan?
(a) Seringapatnam (b) Calicut
(c) Masulipatnam (d) Mangalore

33. In which year did the first English trading company establish itself in India?
(a) 1655 (b) 1651
(c) 1666 (d) 1652

34. Who succeeded Alivardi Khan as the Nawab of Bengal?
(a) Murshid Quli Khan (b) Sirajuddaulah
(c) Shah Alam II (d) Aslam II

35. What was the British Parliament known as?
(a) House of Commons (b) Imperial House
(c) House of Lords (d) White House

36. In which battle were the Marathas defeated by the British?
(a) Fourth Battle of Panipat
(b) Second Battle of Panipat
(c) Third Battle of Panipat
(d) First Battle of Panipat

37. After the Second Anglo-Maratha War, where was the Peshwa exiled?
(a) Amravati (b) Delhi
(c) Bithur (d) Lucknow

38. In what year was the Dutch East India Company established?
(a) 1702 (b) 1752
(c) 1602 (d) 1682

39. In 1765, who was appointed as the Diwan of Bengal by the Mughal emperor?
(a) Nagarseth (b) East India Company
(c) Akbar II (d) Nawab

40. Where is Tipu Sultan's famous toy tiger currently housed?
(a) Victoria and Albert Museum, London
(b) National Museum, New Delhi
(c) Mysore Palace Museum
(d) British Museum, London

41. In which year was Jhansi annexed by Lord Dalhousie?
(a) 1854 (b) 1855
(c) 1858 (d) 1859

42. Where and when was the first English factory established in India?
(a) Mysore in 1620 (b) Tanjore in 1625
(c) Hugli in 1651 (d) Surat in 1613

43. Which state was not under British control in 1857?
(a) Madras (b) Hyderabad
(c) Bombay (d) Benaras

44. The Battle of Plassey occurred in which year?
(a) 1760 (b) 1789
(c) 1755 (d) 1757

45. The First Anglo-Maratha War ended with which treaty?
(a) Treaty of Salbai (b) Treaty of Kanpur
(c) Treaty of Bithur (d) Treaty of Poona

46. Which battle was the first major victory for the British in India?
(a) Battle of Delhi (b) Battle of Mysore
(c) Battle of Plassey (d) Battle of Madras

47. Who accompanied Bahadur Shah Zafar at the time of his arrest?
(a) His advisors (b) His sons
(c) His soldiers (d) His wife

48. Who led the British in the Battle of Plassey against the Nawab of Bengal in 1757?
(a) Warren Hastings (b) Lord Canning
(c) Louis Mountbatten (d) Robert Clive

49. Which region was annexed due to Lord Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse?
(a) Delhi (b) Calcutta
(c) Satara (d) Awadh

50. Who is referred to as the 'Tiger of Mysore'?
(a) Tipu Sultan (b) Haider Ali
(c) Akbar (d) Shah Alam II

51. What was the fate of Bahadur Shah Zafar's sons after the Revolt of 1857?
(a) They were executed by the British in cold blood
(b) They were exiled to Rangoon with their father
(c) They were imprisoned in the Andaman Islands
(d) They were allowed to retain minor princely titles

52. What type of court was the Diwani Adalat?
(a) Civil Court (b) Criminal Court
(c) Faujdari Court (d) Crime Court

53. Who translated the Digest of Hindu Laws into English in 1775?
(a) N. B. Halhed (b) Warren Hastings
(c) Lord Cornwallis (d) Lord Canning

54. In which year did Lord Hastings become Governor-General?
(a) 1813 (b) 1819
(c) 1773 (d) 1775

55. When did the Portuguese discover the sea route to India?
(a) 1500 (b) 1496

(c) 1490 (d) 1498

56. What is the old name of Kolkata?
(a) Kozhikode (b) Madras
(c) Calicut (d) Kalikata

57. During the British-Afghan War, who was the Maharaja of Punjab?
(a) Ranjit Singh (b) Surendra Singh
(c) Fateh Singh (d) Zorawar Singh

58. What does the term 'Farman' refer to?
(a) Royal decree or order (b) King's attire
(c) Tax system (d) Grand palace

59. Who was the administrative head of the Marathas in Pune?
(a) Peshwa (b) Holkar
(c) Bhonsle (d) Scindia

60. On January 7, 1759, who did Robert Clive write to from Calcutta?
(a) The Governor of Bengal
(b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) William Pitt
(d) The English monarch

61. Who was the Governor of Bengal in 1764?
(a) Sujauddaulah (b) Robert Clive
(c) Lord Canning (d) Warren Hastings

62. What was the name of the criminal court in British India?
(a) Diwani Adalat (b) Faujdari Adalat
(c) Civil Adalat (d) Marriage Adalat

63. Which of the following statement is correct?
I. Haidar Ali established his dynasty in Mysore in 1761 AD.
II. Haidar Ali passed away in 1782 AD.
III. Tipu Sultan passed away in 1799 AD.
IV. Aurangzeb passed away in 1707 AD.
V. The first English factory in India was set up at Surat in 1613.
VI. The first English factory along the Hugli River was established in Bengal in 1651.
(a) I III and VI (b) I, II, V
(c) II, IV and VI (d) All of these

MCQ Answer

1-d	2-c	3-b	4-b	5-c
6-a	7-a	8-d	9-b	10-b
11-a	12-d	13-c	14-b	15-a
16-a	17-c	18-b	19-d	20-b
21-b	22-a	23-a	24-a	25-b
26-c	27-d	28-b	29-c	30-a
31-d	32-a	33-b	34-b	35-a
36-c	37-c	38-c	39-b	40-a
41-a	42-d	43-b	44-d	45-a
46-c	47-b	48-d	49-c	50-a
51-a	52-a	53-a	54-a	55-d
56-d	57-a	58-a	59-a	60-c
61-b	62-b	63-d		

3 Ruling the Countryside

The Company Becomes the Diwan:

On 12 August 1765, the Mughal emperor appointed the East India Company as the Diwan of Bengal, Bihar, & Orissa.

- **Location & Depiction:** Historically, this appointment probably took place in Robert Clive's tent with only a few people present. However, in paintings commissioned by Clive, the event is shown in a grand setting to symbolise British power and prestige.
- **Significance:** By becoming Diwan, the East India Company became the chief financial administrator of Bengal. Now it was responsible for:
  - ⇒ Administering the land and organising revenue sources.
  - ⇒ Earning enough revenue to cover the Company's growing expenses.
  - ⇒ Continuing trade by buying Indian goods cheaply and selling British products.

Initial Revenue Policy and Bengal's Crisis:

- The Company, although Diwan, still functioned mainly as a trading company.
- It wanted high revenue but did not establish a proper system for assessing or collecting taxes.
- **Consequences:**
  - ⇒ **Exploitation of Artisans:** They were forced to sell goods (especially fine cotton and silk) at very low prices.
  - ⇒ **Burden on Peasants:** Excessive demands made peasants unable to pay taxes.
  - ⇒ **Decline in Cultivation & Production:** Both artisanal and agricultural sectors saw a downfall.
  - ⇒ **Famine of 1770:** A terrible famine killed about **ten million** people in Bengal (**~one-third** of the population).

The Need to Improve Agriculture:

With the economy in ruins, officials realised that stable agriculture was crucial to ensure continuous revenue flow.

- Debate on how to encourage agricultural development lasted nearly two decades.

Permanent Settlement (1793):

Introduced by: Lord Cornwallis.

Key Terms:

- **Zamindars:** Recognised as owners of the land (rajas and taluqdars became zamindars).
- **Fixed Revenue:** The revenue to be paid by zamindars to the Company was permanently fixed and was not to be increased in future.

Expected Benefits:

⇒ Guaranteed flow of revenue for the Company.

⇒ Incentive for zamindars to invest in land improvement because if production rose, they would keep the extra profit.

Problems with Permanent Settlement:

1. **High Revenue Demand:** Many zamindars could not pay and lost their zamindaris at auctions.
2. **Zamindars' Lack of Investment:** Even if some zamindars later benefited from rising agricultural prices, they had no real motivation to invest in improving land. They preferred simply collecting rent.
3. **Peasants' Insecurity:**
   - Rents were high; peasants had to borrow from moneylenders.

- If they failed to pay, they were often evicted from ancestral land.

The Mahalwari Settlement:

- **Key Proponent:** Holt Mackenzie (1822).
- **Region:** North Western Provinces of the Bengal Presidency (mainly present-day Uttar Pradesh).
- **Main Features:**

⇒ **Village-Based Assessment:** The village (mahal) was seen as an important social institution.

⇒ **Land Measurement & Customs:** Collectors visited villages, measured fields, and recorded rights/customs of different groups.

⇒ **Revenue Calculation:** The estimated revenue of each plot in the village was aggregated to determine total demand for the mahal.

⇒ **Periodic Revision:** The revenue demand was not permanent; it could be revised periodically.

⇒ **Village Headman:** Responsibility of collecting revenue and paying the Company was given to the village headman instead of zamindars.

The Ryotwari (or Munro) System:

- **Developed By:** Captain Alexander Read first, then Thomas Munro.
- **Regions:** Introduced in areas of the South, especially after the Anglo–Mysore wars. Eventually applied to much of South India.
- **Features:**

⇒ **Direct Settlement with Cultivators (Ryots):** In the South, there were no influential zamindars like in Bengal. Hence, officials settled revenue directly with the cultivators.

⇒ **Individual Survey:** Each field was carefully measured and assessed.

⇒ **'Paternal Father Figures':** Thomas Munro believed the British should protect the ryots under their charge.

Flaws in Mahalwari & Ryotwari:

- **High Revenue Assessments:** Eager to increase income, British officials set the revenue so high that many peasants could not pay.
- **Deserted Villages:** When peasants failed to pay, many fled, leading to deserted areas and a drop in cultivation.
- **Unfulfilled Optimism:** The British expected peasants would become prosperous farmers under these systems, but heavy taxes and oppressive methods prevented this.

Crops for Europe:

The British understood that Indian lands could also produce cash crops (opium, indigo, jute, tea, sugarcane, wheat, cotton, rice) demanded by European markets.

Expansion of Cultivation:

- Late 18th century onwards, special emphasis on indigo and opium.
- Later, jute in Bengal, tea in Assam, sugarcane in UP, cotton in Maharashtra and Punjab, wheat in Punjab, and rice in Madras.

Indigo: The Blue Dye and Its History

1. **Importance of Indigo:**
   - Used for a deep blue dye.
   - By 13th century, Indian indigo was known in Europe, but it was expensive and reached in limited quantities.
   - European producers used a local plant called woad for making violet/blue dyes, but woad was inferior to indigo in colour quality.
   - European woad cultivators initially banned import of indigo to safeguard their interests.
   - By the 17th century, bans were lifted due to the superior quality of Indian indigo.
2. **Rising Demand for Indian Indigo:**
   - Industrialisation in Britain (late 18th century) led to massive growth in cotton production, increasing demand

for indigo dye.

- Traditional sources (West Indies, Americas) collapsed for various reasons (like slave revolts).
- **India Became Main Supplier:** By 1810, 95% of the indigo imported by Britain came from Bengal.

Systems of Indigo Cultivation:

1. **Nij Cultivation:**

Planters produced indigo on land directly controlled or owned by them.

Challenges:

- **Scarcity of Large Fertile Plots:** Most fertile land was already under cultivation for rice; acquiring huge continuous areas was difficult.
- **Labour Shortage:** Required large numbers of workers at peak season, but peasants were busy with their own fields.
- **Need for Ploughs and Bullocks:** One bigha needed two ploughs, so 1,000 bighas would require 2,000 ploughs — huge investment and maintenance cost.

2. **Ryoti Cultivation:**

- **Most Common Method:** Planters forced ryots (peasants) to sign contracts (satta).
- Sometimes, village headmen were pressurised to sign contracts on behalf of all ryots.

Loans & Contracts:

⇒ Planters gave cash advances at low interest.
⇒ In return, ryots had to reserve at least 25% of their land for indigo.
⇒ The planter provided seeds and implements; the ryots prepared the fields and grew the crop.

Cycle of Debt:

⇒ After delivering the harvested indigo, peasants often took another loan, tying them perpetually to this system.
⇒ Indigo prices paid to ryots were very low.

- **Soil Exhaustion:** Indigo's deep roots depleted soil fertility; land used for indigo was less productive for future rice cultivation.

The "Blue Rebellion" (1859) and Its Aftermath:

- **Start of Rebellion:** In March 1859, thousands of ryots in Bengal refused to grow indigo.

Methods of Protest:

⇒ Refusal to pay rents or take advances.
⇒ Social boycott of those working for planters.
⇒ Attacks on indigo factories with traditional weapons.
⇒ Gomasthas (planters' agents) were often beaten up.

- **Reasons for Ryots' Confidence:**

⇒ **Local Support:** Village headmen and some zamindars backed the ryots as they resented planters' growing power.
⇒ **Belief in British Government Support:** After the 1857 Revolt, there was fear of further rebellions; peasants thought the government might side with them to prevent unrest.

Government Response:

⇒ The Lieutenant Governor toured the indigo districts in 1859.
⇒ Magistrate Ashley Eden issued a notice stating ryots could not be forced to accept indigo contracts.
⇒ Military was brought in to protect planters, yet the government set up the Indigo Commission to investigate.

Indigo Commission (1860):

- Held planters guilty of oppressive methods.
- Declared indigo cultivation unprofitable for ryots.
- Instructed ryots to honour existing contracts but also gave them freedom to refuse future cultivation of indigo.

Shift to Bihar & Later Developments:

- After the Bengal rebellion, many planters shifted their operations to Bihar.
- **Synthetic Dyes:** By the late 19th century, the discovery of synthetic dyes affected the global indigo market. Still,

British planters in India continued for some time.

Champaran Movement (1917):

⇒ Mahatma Gandhi was persuaded by a farmer from Bihar to see the plight of indigo cultivators.

⇒ Gandhi's involvement in Champaran marked a significant moment in India's struggle for independence, highlighting the exploitation by indigo planters and pressing for peasants' rights.

Terms & Definitions:

1. **Diwan:** Chief financial administrator, responsible for revenue collection and governance of a region.
2. **Zamindar:** Landholder given official recognition under the Permanent Settlement to collect rent from peasants.
3. **Ryot:** Cultivator or peasant.
4. **Mahal:** In British revenue records, usually a revenue estate which could be a single village or a group of villages.
5. **Bigha:** Traditional unit of measurement of land. In Bengal, standardised by the British to roughly one-third of an acre.
6. **Planter:** European or local entrepreneur who owned/manageed large tracts of land to cultivate cash crops like indigo, tea, or coffee.
7. **Gomastha:** Agent of the planter or the Company, engaged in revenue collection or in enforcing cultivation contracts.

1. When did a severe famine affect Bengal?
   (a) 1775 (b) 1779
   (c) 1764 (d) 1770
2. In which year did Mahatma Gandhi retur. o India from South Africa?
   (a) 9 January 1915 (b) 9 April 1916
   (c) 9 March 1920 (d) 9 March 1915
3. When was the East India Company appointed as the Diwan of Bengal by the Mughal Emperor?
   (a) 12 August 1755 (b) 12 August 1765
   (c) 12 August 1775 (d) 12 August 1745
4. In which year did the East India Company gain the right to collect Bengal's revenue (Diwani)?
   (a) 1762 (b) 1764
   (c) 1765 (d) 1770
5. What fraction of Bengal's population died in the 1770 famine?
   (a) One fifth (b) One half
   (c) One third (d) Two thirds
6. After his victory, Robert Clive gained the Diwani of which territories?
   (a) Bengal (b) Bihar
   (c) Odisha (d) All of these
7. As the Diwan of Bengal, what was the East India Company responsible for managing?
   (a) Defence
   (b) Religious matters
   (c) Financial administration
   (d) Judiciary
8. Who introduced the Mahalwari system in 1822?
   (a) Holt Mackenzie (b) Robert Mills
   (c) Warren Hastings (d) Cornwille
9. In which region was the Mahalwari system introduced?
   (a) Rajasthan
   (b) Punjab and Western Uttar Pradesh
   (c) Bihar
   (d) Madhya Pradesh
10. What action did the British take if zamindars couldn't pay revenue?
    (a) Imprisoned them (b) Auctioned their land
    (c) Punished them (d) Took their goods
11. On which date was Hadji Mulla interviewed by the Indigo Commission?
    (a) 10 July 1860 (b) 5 June 1860
    (c) 15 June 1860 (d) 3 July 1860
12. Why did many artisans leave Bengal's villages during Company rule?
    (a) They were forced to sell goods at very low prices.
    (b) Floods destroyed their work.
    (c) They faced hunger due to famine.
    (d) They lacked access to raw materials.
13. What did zamindars collect from the farmers?
    (a) Rent (b) Food
    (c) Goods (d) Money
14. Which land revenue system was implemented in the

Madras and Bombay Presidencies during British rule?
(a) Zamindari System (b) Mahalwari System
(c) Ryotwari System (d) Permanent Settlement

15. Who was the Governor-General of India in 1793?
(a) Charles Cornwallis (b) Warren Hastings
(c) Louis Chole (d) George Martin

16. In which year was the Mahalwari system introduced?
(a) 1830 (b) 1822
(c) 1854 (d) 1825

17. Under the Permanent Settlement system, what were Rajas and Talukdars called?
(a) Zamindars (b) Diwans
(c) Kings (d) Peasants

18. Which system was introduced in 1819?
(a) Ryotwari system (b) Mahalwari system
(c) Agricultural changes (d) Judiciary reforms

19. Which land revenue system placed the responsibility of revenue collection on the village headman?
(a) Zamindari System (b) Mahalwari System
(c) Ryotwari System (d) Permanent Settlement

20. In which part of India did Munro introduce the Ryotwari system?
(a) Western India (b) North India
(c) South India (d) Central India

21. In which year was the Permanent Settlement system officially abolished?
(a) 1920 (b) 1955
(c) 1985 (d) 1972

22. Approximately how many people died in the Bengal famine of 1770?
(a) 1 million (b) 20 million
(c) 10 million (d) 25 million

23. Why did many farmers lose their land during the British era?
(a) High rent (b) Lack of rainfall
(c) Famine (d) Imprisonment

24. Who was the Governor-General when the East India Company gained Diwani rights?
(a) Robert Clive (b) James Mill
(c) Lord Mountbatten (d) Lord Dalhousie

25. Under the Mahalwari system, what was each village unit called?
(a) Peasants (b) Mahal
(c) Towns (d) Houses

26. Who served as the Governor of Madras in 1819?
(a) Thomas Munro (b) Jacob Smith
(c) Holt Mackenzie (d) Franklin

27. Who was responsible for collecting rent under the Permanent Settlement system?
(a) District Collector (b) Zamindars
(c) Subedar (d) Talukdar

28. Which reform was introduced by the Company in 1793?
(a) Agricultural changes
(b) Judiciary reforms
(c) Permanent Settlement
(d) Administrative changes

29. Which of the following was a plantation crop introduced during British rule?
(a) Tea, Indigo, Jute (b) Coffee, Sugarcane
(c) Rubber, Cotton (d) All of these

30. Under the terms of the Permanent Settlement, who were recognized as zamindars?
(a) Village communities (b) Individual cultivators
(c) None of these (d) Rajas and Taluqdars

31. Who is credited with devising the Mahalwari system for land revenue?
(a) James Mill (b) Charles Cornwallis
(c) Holt Mackenzie (d) Robert Clive

32. Who invented the Morris cotton print?
(a) William Morris (b) John Morris
(c) Robert Morris (d) Morris Will

33. Which type of market was commonly organized in Murshidabad, Bengal?
(a) Weekly market (Haat)
(b) Local bazaar
(c) Wholesale trade center
(d) Export trade market

34. Who was responsible for collecting revenue under the Mahalwari system?
(a) British officers (b) Soldiers
(c) Village headmen (d) Zamindars

35. During British rule, which crops did the British expand cultivation for trade?
(a) Opium, Cotton (b) Indigo, Jute
(c) Tea, Sugarcane (d) All of these

36. In the context of land revenue systems, who were referred to as "ryots"?
(a) Landlords (b) Village headmen
(c) Peasant cultivators (d) British officers

MCQ Answer

1-d	2-a	3-b	4-c	5-c
6-d	7-c	8-a	9-b	10-b
11-b	12-a	13-a	14-c	15-a
16-b	17-a	18-a	19-b	20-c
21-b	22-c	23-a	24-a	25-b
26-a	27-b	28-c	29-d	30-d
31-c	32-a	33-a	34-c	35-d
36-c				

4 Tribals, Dikus, and the Vision of a Golden Age

The World of Birsa Munda:

- **Birsa Munda (1895):** A tribal leader roaming the forests and villages of Chottanagpur (now in Jharkhand).
- **Miraculous Powers:** People believed he could cure diseases and multiply grain.
- **His Declaration:** Claimed that God appointed him to save his people from slavery under dikus (outsiders).
- **Followers:** Included various tribes (Mundas, Santhals, Oraons) who were troubled by changes under British rule — their way of life, livelihoods, and religious practices were under threat.

How Did Tribal Groups Live?

By the 19th century, there was no single way of life common to all tribal groups. Different tribal communities followed different livelihoods.

1. **Jhum Cultivators (Shifting Cultivation):**
   - Practised on small forest patches.

   Method:
   ⇒ Cut treetops to let sunlight reach the ground.
   ⇒ Burn vegetation, spread the ash to fertilise soil (contains potash).
   ⇒ Use hoe to scratch the soil and broadcast seeds (no ploughing).
   ⇒ Move to a new patch once the crop is harvested, leaving the old field fallow (uncultivated) for several years.
   - **Regions:** Common in the hilly/forested areas of north-east and central India.
   - **Importance:** Required free movement within forests and access to land and forest produce.
2. **Hunters and Gatherers:**
   - *Example*: The Khonds of Orissa.

   Lifestyle:
   ⇒ Collective hunts; meat shared among the clan.
   ⇒ Collected fruits, roots, sal and mahua seeds (for oil), and used forest herbs for medicine.
   ⇒ Sold forest produce in local markets or exchanged it for other necessities.
   - **Challenges:** When forest produce reduced, they had to search for wage labour in nearby areas. But some (like the Baigas) considered it beneath their dignity to work as labourers for others.
3. **Herding and Animal Rearing:**
   - **Pastoral Communities:** Moved seasonally with herds.

   Examples:
   ⇒ Van Gujjars of the Punjab hills (cattle herders)
   ⇒ Gaddis of Kulu (shepherds)
   ⇒ Labadis of Andhra Pradesh (cattle herders)
   ⇒ Bakarwals of Kashmir (goat rearers).
4. **Settled Cultivation:**
   - Many tribal groups began settled cultivation much before the 19th century.
   - Used **ploughs** and cultivated on fixed fields.
   - **Land Ownership:** Often belonged to the entire clan.
     ⇒ All members were considered descendants of original settlers, thus had common land rights.
   - Over time, some members became more powerful (chiefs, landlords), renting out land to others instead of cultivating themselves.

- **British View:** The colonial authorities considered settled tribal groups like the Gonds and Santhals as more civilised compared to shifting cultivators or hunters.

Impact of Colonial Rule on Tribal Lives:

1. **Changes in the Role of Tribal Chiefs:**
   - **Before British Rule:** Chiefs had significant autonomy, administered their territories, managed forests, and had economic power.

   Under British Rule:
   - ⇒ Chiefs could keep land titles for certain villages, but lost administrative authority.
   - ⇒ Forced to follow British laws and pay tribute.
   - ⇒ Had to discipline their own people on behalf of the British.
   - ⇒ Lost the traditional prestige they once enjoyed.
2. **Shifting Cultivators and Land Settlements:**
   - The British disliked moving communities and wanted tribals to settle as peasant cultivators to generate a stable revenue.
   - **Land Settlements:** Surveyed and measured land, fixed revenue demands, declared some people as owners and others as tenants.

   Difficulties:
   - ⇒ Jhum cultivation in dry, hilly areas wasn't easily replaced by plough cultivation.
   - ⇒ Where plough cultivation failed, tribals protested and the British had to allow partial continuation of shifting cultivation in certain forest tracts.
3. **Forest Laws and Their Consequences:**
   - **Reserved Forests:** British classified many forests as state property to control valuable timber.
   - **Restrictions:** Tribals were often barred from practising jhum cultivation, hunting, or collecting forest produce in Reserved Forests.
     - ⇒ Led to hardship and displacement; many had to seek wage labour outside.
   - **Forest Villages:** To ensure a steady supply of cheap labour, British officials gave small land patches to jhum cultivators on condition they would work for the Forest Department, cutting timber and protecting forests.
4. **The Problem with Traders, Moneylenders, and Markets:**
   - **Increasing Trade:** During the 19th century, traders ventured deeper into forest areas to buy produce (like silk cocoons) and offer cash loans.

   Silk Growers:
   - ⇒ **Example:** Santhals of Hazaribagh in Jharkhand reared cocoons.
   - ⇒ Middlemen purchased cocoons at very low rates (3–4 for 1,000 cocoons) but sold them at five times the price in bigger markets.
   - ⇒ **Result:** Tribal silk growers earned little profit, remained in debt.
   - **Debt Cycle:** Moneylenders charged high interest; tribals often ended up in cycles of poverty. This made them resent traders and moneylenders as exploitative dikus.
5. **Search for Work:**
   - **Tea Plantations & Coal Mines:** From late 19th century, tribals were recruited (often forcibly) for low wages in:
     - ⇒ Tea plantations of Assam
     - ⇒ Coal mines of Jharkhand.
   - **Contractor System:** Contractors prevented them from leaving, creating harsh working conditions with very little pay.

Tribal Revolts and Resistance:

1. **General Tribal Uprisings:**

   Tribal groups revolted against unfair laws, harsh taxes, forest restrictions, and exploitation by dikus. Major rebellions included:

⇒ Kol Rebellion (1831–32)
⇒ Bastar Rebellion (1910)
⇒ Santhal Revolt (1855)
⇒ Warli Revolt (1940)

2. **Birsa Munda and the Vision of a Golden Age:**

Birth & Early Life: Birsa was born in the mid-1870s among the Mundas of Chottanagpur. As a child, he grazed sheep, played the flute, and learned about old Munda uprisings.

Influences:

- **Local missionary school:** Heard about Kingdom of Heaven and the promise of regaining lost rights through adopting certain beliefs.
- **Vaishnav Preacher:** Emphasised purity, piety, and gave Birsa the idea of a more moral and pure society.

Message:

- Urged Mundas to give up liquor and superstitions like witchcraft and sorcery.
- Called for a return to the glorious past (satyug), where the land was cultivated collectively, people lived honestly, and they enjoyed freedom from exploitation.

Revolt Against Dikus:

- Identified the British, moneylenders, landlords, and missionaries as outsiders disrupting the Munda way of life.
- Aspired to establish "Munda Raj" with himself as the leader.

Impact:

- In 1895, Birsa was arrested and jailed for two years.
- After his release in 1897, he expanded his movement; followers attacked symbols of colonial power (police stations, churches, property of moneylenders).
- Raised the white flag to symbolise Birsa Raj.
- Birsa died of cholera in 1900, and the movement declined.

Terms and Definitions:

- **Dikus:** Outsiders, including British officials, moneylenders, missionaries, landlords, whom the tribals blamed for their suffering.
- **Jhum Cultivation:** Also called shifting cultivation, involves clearing and burning forest patches, sowing seeds in ash-fertilised soil.
- **Fallow:** Land left uncultivated for soil to regain fertility.
- **Reserved Forests:** Forests controlled by the British government for timber; tribals could not freely use them.
- **Vaishnav:** Worshipper of Lord Vishnu; emphasises purity and devotion.

1. Which tribe mainly lives in Odisha?
(a) Santhal (b) Orans
(c) Dongria Kandha (d) Bhotia

2. Who were the Van Gujjars of the Punjab region?
(a) Reared goats (b) Village heads
(c) Cattle herders (d) Money lenders

3. What term did tribals use for the British?
(a) Devta (b) Raja
(c) Killers (d) Dikus

4. Which tree seeds were commonly used by tribals to extract cooking oil?
(a) Banyan seeds (b) Sal seeds
(c) Teak seeds (d) Neem Seeds

5. In which type of regions is shifting cultivation commonly practiced?
(a) Forested regions (b) Hilly areas
(c) Both (a) and (b) (d) Plains and valleys

6. Which of the following is NOT an example of a tribal revolt against moneylenders and traders?
(a) Santhal Rebellion (b) Kol Uprising
(c) Warli Revolt (d) Tebhaga Movement

7. In which year did Birsa Munda pass away?
(a) 1897 (b) 1900
(c) 1901 (d) 1899

8. Which seed is commonly used by tribals to prepare food?
(a) Avocado (b) Mango
(c) Mahua (d) Palash

9. During British rule in Bihar, which mines were tribals forced to work in?
(a) Petroleum (b) Gold
(c) Iron (d) Coal

10. Which plant's flowers are mostly used by tribals for dyeing clothes?
(a) Lotus (b) Kusum
(c) Mango (d) Rose

11. Who was a well-known tribal leader during India's freedom struggle?
(a) Bhagoji Naik (b) Ambroz Naik
(c) Arjun Munda (d) Birsa Munda

12. Which tribe stays away from contact with the outside world?
(a) Khasi (b) Gujjars
(c) Orans (d) Jarawas

13. The Khonds are primarily associated with which region?
(a) Chhattisgarh (b) Odisha
(c) Jharkhand (d) Madhya Pradesh

14. In which year did the Warli revolt take place?
(a) 1942 (b) 1938
(c) 1945 (d) 1940

15. Gaddis are traditionally recognized as:
(a) Shepherds (b) Farmers
(c) Fishermen (d) Traders

16. What is shifting cultivation called in Madhya Pradesh?
(a) Jhuming (b) Bewar
(c) Ploughing (d) Buwai

17. What is the role of the Kotwal (or Kotwar) in the village as described in the song?
(a) To act as a village watchman
(b) To maintain law and order
(c) To collect taxes
(d) To assist in farming

18. Which animal is often reared by tribals?
(a) Cat (b) Dog
(c) Snake (d) Yak

19. Which tribe is well-known in Maharashtra?
(a) Bhotia (b) Mala Irular
(c) Bhils (d) Banjara

20. Which coal mines are located in tribal regions of India?
(a) Jharia and Raniganj (b) Korba and Singrauli
(c) Talcher and Neyveli (d) None of these

21. Which tribe lives in Kashmir?
(a) Bakarwal (b) Santhal
(c) Jhum (d) Jarawas

22. Who were the people that followed Birsa Munda?
(a) Vaishyas (b) Bhils
(c) Brahmans (d) Orans

23. Which shepherd tribe is based in Himachal Pradesh?
(a) Khasi (b) Bhil
(c) Santhal (d) Gaddis

24. What kind of animals did the Bakarwals of Kashmir primarily rear?
(a) Sheep and goats (b) Cattle and buffaloes
(c) Horses and camels (d) Donkeys and mules

25. When and where did Birsa Munda pass away?
(a) June 9, 1900, in Ranchi Jail
(b) July 15, 1899, in Hazaribagh Jail
(c) May 25, 1901, in Kolkata Jail
(d) August 5, 1902, in Jharkhand

26. Which community does "Birsa" belong to?
(a) Santhal (b) Oraon
(c) Munda (d) Gond

27. When did the Santhal revolt happen?
(a) 1857 (b) 1860
(c) 1862 (d) 1855

28. What was the role of Baigas in Central India?
(a) Traders and merchants
(b) Shifting cultivators and forest dwellers
(c) Tribal chieftains
(d) Fishermen and boat makers

29. Before British rule, who held the highest authority in tribal areas?
(a) King (b) Minister
(c) Advisors (d) Tribal Chief

30. Which of the following tribes does not belong to Jharkhand?
(a) Oraons (b) Munda
(c) Bhil (d) Santhal

31. The Oran tribe is mostly found in which state?
(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Kerala
(c) Punjab (d) Jharkhand

32. The British could not settle which group in one place?
(a) Farmers (b) Villagers
(c) Tribals (d) Jhum cultivators

33. What emotion does the person singing the song express?
(a) Pain, suffering, and a feeling of homelessness
(b) Gratitude for labor and survival
(c) Protest against injustice
(d) Happiness with life

34. What was the officially declared cause of Birsa Munda's death?
(a) Malaria (b) Cholera
(c) Tuberculosis (d) Poisoning

35. In the Chhota Nagpur region, who were referred to as 'Dikus'?
(a) Outsiders (b) Village elders
(c) Tribal leaders (d) Local traders

36. Which rebellion happened in Central India in 1910?
(a) Oran Revolt (b) Worli Revolt
(c) Jarawa Revolt (d) Bastar Rebellion

37. How is Mahua traditionally used?
(a) To make alcoholic beverages
(b) To prepare herbal medicines
(c) As a natural sweetener
(d) To extract essential oils

MCQ Answer

1-c	2-c	3-d	4-b	5-c
6-d	7-d	8-c	9-d	10-b
11-d	12-d	13-b	14-d	15-a
16-b	17-c	18-d	19-d	20-a
21-a	22-d	23-d	24-a	25-a
26-c	27-d	28-b	29-d	30-c
31-d	32-d	33-a	34-b	35-a
36-d	37-a			

5 When People Revolt: 1857 and After

Nawabs Lose Their Power:

- **Eroding Authority:** From the mid-18th century, **nawabs** and **rajas** steadily lost authority. British Residents were stationed at their courts, their armies disbanded, and revenue sources taken away.

1. **Subsidiary Alliance and Annexation:**
   - **Example:** In 1801, Awadh was forced into a subsidiary alliance. By 1856, Lord Dalhousie annexed Awadh, accusing its nawab of misrule.
   - **Doctrine of Lapse:** Adopted heirs were often not recognised by the Company. Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi's plea to accept her adopted son as heir was rejected. Nana Saheb's request for his father's pension was also turned down.
2. **Ending Mughal Rule:**
   - **Coins:** The Mughal king's name was removed from Company-minted coins.
   - **Bahadur Shah Zafar:** Governor-General Dalhousie decided that upon Bahadur Shah Zafar's death, his descendants would lose the title of king. In 1856, Governor-General Canning declared that Bahadur Shah Zafar would be the last Mughal ruler and his successors would only be called princes.

The Peasants and the Sepoys:

1. **Discontent among Peasants and Zamindars:**
   - **High Taxes & Rigid Revenue Collection:** Farmers found it difficult to pay high taxes; many lost their lands to moneylenders after failing to repay loans.
   - **Anger Spread:** This anger in rural areas influenced sepoys since many sepoys had peasant backgrounds and were connected to villages.
2. **Discontent among Sepoys:**
   - **Pay & Conditions:** Sepoys were unhappy about low pay and poor service conditions compared to British soldiers.
   - **Overseas Service:** A prevalent belief was that crossing the sea would cause a loss of religion or caste. When sepoys were asked to go to Burma by sea in 1824, they refused, were punished, and remained resentful.
   - **New Rule (1856):** Anyone joining the army had to agree to serve overseas, further fuelling resentment among sepoys.

Responses to Reforms:

Social Reforms by the British:

⇒ Stopping **sati** and encouraging **widow remarriage.**

⇒ Promoting **English-language education.**

⇒ Allowing **Christian missionaries** to operate freely.

⇒ **Law of 1850:** Made it easier for Indians to convert to Christianity; converts could inherit ancestral property.

- **Reaction:** Many Indians felt the British aimed to destroy their religions and social customs. Others favoured social reforms but were wary of the Company's intentions.

Through the Eyes of the People:

1. **The List of Eighty-Four Rules:**

Vishnubhatt Godse's Account (Majha Pravaas):

⇒ Heard from sepoys that the English intended to destroy Hindu and Muslim religions.

⇒ Rumours of 84 new rules disliked by kings and princes.

⇒ Fear and anger circulated, creating a mood for rebellion.

2. "There Was Soon Excitement in Every Regiment"

Memoirs of Subedar Sitaram Pande (From Sepoy to Subedar):

⇒ Believed the annexation of Awadh stirred deep distrust among sepoys.

⇒ Agents of Nawab of Awadh and Mughal emperor circulated stories of British treachery.

⇒ *Cartridges Controversy*: Rumours spread that the new Enfield rifle cartridges were coated with cow and pig fat, defiling both Hindus and Muslims.

⇒ Officers tried to calm sepoys, but discontent kept growing.

A Mutiny Becomes a Popular Uprising:

A mutiny is when soldiers collectively disobey their officers. In 1857, this mutiny in the Bengal Army quickly became **a widespread rebellion**. Different social groups—sepoys, peasants, artisans, rulers, nawabs—came together, believing they had a **common enemy** in the British.

From Meerut to Delhi:

1. **Mangal Pandey (8 April 1857):** A young sepoy hanged for attacking British officers at Barrackpore.
2. **Cartridges Refusal at Meerut (9 May 1857):** 85 sepoys dismissed and jailed for refusing the new cartridges.
3. **Revolt in Meerut (10 May 1857):**
   - Fellow sepoys freed the imprisoned soldiers.
   - Killed British officers, seized arms, set properties ablaze, and declared war on the firangis (foreigners).
   - They decided to restore the Mughal emperor's authority.
4. **Delhi Falls to the Rebels (11 May 1857):**
   - Sepoys rode overnight to Delhi, inciting regiments there to rebel.
   - British officers killed, arms seized, and buildings torched.
   - Bahadur Shah Zafar was declared the emperor of Hindustan by sepoys.
5. **Emperor's Response:**
   - Initially reluctant, but eventually wrote letters to Indian rulers and chiefs urging them to form a confederacy against the British.
   - This step had massive implications as many rulers saw an opportunity to regain their territories under Mughal suzerainty.

The Uprising Spreads:

- **Early Stages:** A week's gap after Delhi's fall due to slow communication.
- **Waves of Mutinies:** Regiments across north India revolted and marched towards Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow.
- **Popular Support:** Locals—peasants, zamindars, dispossessed rulers—rallied around those willing to fight the British.

Key Leaders:

- **Nana Saheb (Kanpur):** Proclaimed himself Peshwa (Maratha leader), acknowledging Bahadur Shah Zafar.
- **Birjis Qadr (Lucknow):** Son of deposed Nawab Wajid Ali Shah. Supported by his mother Begum Hazrat Mahal.
- **Rani Lakshmibai (Jhansi):** Led rebel sepoys, joined forces with Tantia Tope (general of Nana Saheb).
- **Rani Avantibai Lodhi (Mandla region, MP):** Raised an army of 4,000 to resist the British.
- **Ahmadullah Shah (Faizabad):** A Maulvi who inspired people by predicting the end of British rule.
- **Bakht Khan (Bareilly):** Took charge of rebel forces in Delhi, became a key military figure.
- **Kunwar Singh (Bihar):** Elderly zamindar who fought the British for many months.

The Company Fights Back:

- **Reinforcements from England:** Additional troops arrived to repress the rebellion.
- **New Laws:** Made it easier to convict rebels.

Recapture of Delhi (September 1857):

⇒ Bahadur Shah Zafar was put on trial and given life imprisonment.
⇒ He and his wife, Begum Zinat Mahal, were exiled to Rangoon (Burma).
⇒ Bahadur Shah Zafar died there in 1862.

Despite Delhi falling, rebel resistance continued. The British recaptured:

⇒ Lucknow (March 1858)
⇒ Rani Lakshmibai was killed in battle (June 1858)
⇒ Rani Avantibai died resisting in Kheri
⇒ Tantia Tope fought a guerrilla war but was eventually captured and executed (April 1859)

Winning Back Loyalty:

⇒ **Rewards:** British offered rewards to landholders who had not killed Europeans.
⇒ **Severe Punishments:** Many sepoys, nawabs, and rebels were hanged or executed.

- By the end of 1859, the British had largely regained control but realised they could not continue with the same policies.

Aftermath: Major Changes in British Policy

Following the Government of India Act (1858), several significant changes were introduced:

1. **End of Company Rule:**
   - Powers transferred to the British Crown.
   - A Secretary of State for India, aided by an India Council, would manage Indian affairs.
   - The Governor-General now took the title Viceroy, acting as the Crown's personal representative.
2. **Assurance to Rulers:**
   - No more annexations.
   - Rulers allowed to pass on kingdoms to heirs (including adopted sons).
   - Had to accept the British Queen as their Sovereign Paramount.
3. **Changes in the Army:**
   - Fewer Indian soldiers, more British soldiers.
   - Recruitment shifted towards Gurkhas, Sikhs, and Pathans instead of Awadh, Bihar, or central/south India.
4. **Suspicion Towards Muslims:**
   - The British blamed them significantly for the revolt; widespread confiscation of Muslim land and property.
5. **Respect for Customary Social and Religious Practices:**
   - The British decided not to interfere openly with traditional customs and religions.
6. **Protection for Landlords and Zamindars:**
   - Policies framed to secure their land rights, ensuring their loyalty to British rule.

The Khurda Uprising (1817): A Case Study

(Important to note how anti-British sentiments had been brewing even before 1857.)

- **Location:** Khurda (in south-eastern Orissa).

Background:

⇒ **Late 16th Century:** Khurda was a small but significant kingdom.
⇒ **Loss of Territories:** Raja Birakishore Dev and later his son Mukunda Dev II lost four parganas and other privileges to the Marathas, then hoped British would restore them.
⇒ **Betrayal:** After occupying Orissa (1803), the British refused to restore Mukunda Dev II's lands or rights over Jagannath Temple.

⇒ British imposed short-term revenue settlements, demanded high taxes, and resumed service tenures, hitting the Paiks (ex-militia) severely.

Buxi Jagabandhu:

⇒ Hereditary military commander of Khurda's king.
⇒ Lost his estate, reduced to poverty, saw widespread distress.
⇒ Led Paiks in a full-blown uprising in March 1817 against British oppression.

Course of the Uprising:

⇒ Paiks attacked government establishments, overcame local police stations, and spread the rebellion.
⇒ Declared Mukunda Dev II as king in Puri.
⇒ The British imposed Martial Law. Many Paiks were killed; Buxi Jagabandhu and others continued resistance.

Aftermath:

⇒ The British eventually contained the uprising by May 1817 but faced prolonged guerrilla resistance.
⇒ Introduced reforms: lowered salt price, improved police/justice system, dismissed corrupt officers, and restored some landholders' rights.
⇒ King's son, Ram Chandra Dev III, regained temple management with a grant.

1. Who was the wife of Bahadur Shah Zafar?
   (a) Begum Gazi Khatun (b) Begum Hazrat Mahal
   (c) Begum Zinat Mahal (d) Begum Gazal Mahal
2. Who led a group of soldiers from Bareilly to Delhi during the revolt?
   (a) Kunwar Singh (b) Tantia Tope
   (c) Dara Shikoh (d) Bakht Khan
3. On which date did Lt. Colonel Tyler officially communicate British fears through a telegram?
   (a) 6 August 1857 (b) 12 April 1857
   (c) 6 June 1858 (d) 12 April 1857
4. In which year was the Mahalwari system introduced?
   (a) 1833 (b) 1822
   (c) 1826 (d) 1830
5. Which military leader recaptured Delhi in 1857?
   (a) Lord Dalhousie (b) William Taylor
   (c) John Nicholson (d) Colonel Neil
6. Who introduced the Zamindari system in 1793?
   (a) Thomas Macaulay (b) Lord Wellesley
   (c) Lord Cornwallis (d) Warren Hastings
7. Who gave the order to annex Jhansi?
   (a) Lord Canning (b) Warren Hastings
   (c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Clive
8. Under the Ryotwari system, who was granted ownership rights?
   (a) Zamindars (b) British officials
   (c) Peasants (d) Merchants
9. Which of the following states was annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse?
   (a) Nagpur, 1853 (b) Satara, 1848
   (c) Sambalpur, 1850 (d) All of these
10. In 1824, sepoys were punished for refusing to go to which country?
    (a) Burma (b) Africa
    (c) England (d) America
11. After the revolt of 1857, the British recruited more soldiers from which community?
    (a) Muslims (b) Awadhis
    (c) Madrasis (d) Sikhs
12. Who progressively lost their authority and honour over time?
    (a) Rajas (b) Nawabs
    (c) Both (a) and (b) (d) None of these
13. Who wrote the book *Majha Pravaas*?
    (a) Vishnubhatt Godse
    (b) Govind Sakharam Sardesai
    (c) Kashinath Mahadev Padhye
    (d) Raghunath Rao

14. After 1830, which group was allowed by the Company to preach in India?
(a) Muslim missionaries
(b) Buddhist missionaries
(c) Christian missionaries
(d) Hindu missionaries

15. What was the Zamindari system also referred to as?
(a) Permanent Settlement System
(b) Ryotwari System
(c) Mahalwari System
(d) None of these

16. What is the exact birth date of Rani Lakshmi Bai, the brave leader of Jhansi?
(a) 19 November 1828 (b) 18 November 1827
(c) 20 November 1828 (d) None of these

17. What is the term for soldiers disobeying their officers?
(a) Mutiny (b) Rebellion
(c) Resistance (d) Revolt

18. Who were appointed in the courts of Nawabs by the British in the mid-18th century?
(a) Ministers (b) Advisors
(c) Residents (d) Spies

19. What is the title of the book authored by Sitaram Pande?
(a) Memoirs of a Sepoy (b) From Sepoy to Subedar
(c) The Revolt of 1857 (d) Tales of a Soldier

20. Who was the wife of Bahadur Shah Zafar during the Revolt of 1857?
(a) Begum Zinat Mahal (b) Begum Taj Mahal
(c) Begum Ashraf Mahal (d) Begum Akhtar Mahal

21. Under the Mahalwari system, what percentage of revenue had to be paid during dry land conditions?
(a) 20% (b) 25%
(c) 50% (d) 75%

22. Who was the adopted son of Peshwa Baji Rao II?
(a) Mahadji Shinde (b) Nana Saheb
(c) Peshwa Baji Rao I (d) Rao Saheb

23. Where was Bahadur Shah Zafar imprisoned after the revolt?
(a) Kathmandu (b) Rangoon
(c) Lahore (d) Calcutta

24. On which date did the mutiny officially begin at Meerut?
(a) 10th May 1856 (b) 10th May 1857
(c) 10th May 1858 (d) 10th May 1859

25. Which queen negotiated with the British to recognize her adopted son's right to the throne?
(a) Rani Padmavati (b) None
(c) Rani Durgavati (d) Rani Lakshmi Bai

26. Who was officially recognized as the leader of the 1857 rebellion?
(a) Begum Hazrat Mahal
(b) Nawab Wajid Ali Shah
(c) Bahadur Shah Zafar
(d) Rani Lakshmi Bai

27. Which was one of the last territories annexed by the British in 1856?
(a) Jhansi (b) Lahore
(c) Kanpur (d) Awadh

28. Who was the first soldier to be hanged for his role in the 1857 revolt?
(a) Shahuji (b) Batukeshwar Dutt
(c) Mahadji Shinde (d) Mangal Pandey

29. From where did the British East India Company bring reinforcements to suppress the 1857 rebellion?
(a) America (b) Canada
(c) Australia (d) England

30. Identify the cities that were significant centres during the Revolt of 1857.
(a) Kanpur, Lucknow, Meerut
(b) Bangaluru, Gujarat, Madras
(c) Jhansi, Bareilly, Delhi
(d) Both (a) and (c)

31. From which region was Vir Kunwar Singh, an old zamindar, associated during the 1857 uprising?
(a) Bihar (b) Gujarat
(c) Punjab (d) Delhi

32. Who authored the book *Majha Pravaas*?
(a) Vishnubhat Godse
(b) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
(c) Govind Ballabh Pant
(d) An English historian

33. Which revolt was the largest armed resistance against British rule in the 19th century?
(a) 1859 (b) 1861
(c) 1857 (d) 1860

34. Who was declared the leader of the 1857 revolt?
(a) Bahadur Shah Zafar
(b) Nana Saheb
(c) Nawab Wajid Ali Shah
(d) Rani Lakshmibai

35. Brijis Qadr was the deposed son of which historical figure?
(a) Bahadur Shah Zafar (b) Wajid Ali Shah
(c) Tipu Sultan (d) None of these

36. Who served as the general for Nana Saheb during the revolt?
(a) Tantia Tope (b) Mangal Pandey
(c) Begum Hazrat Mahal (d) Baji Rao II

37. Where did the revolt of 1857 start?
(a) Delhi (b) Cawnpur
(c) Calcutta (d) Meerut

38. Bahadur Shah II was exiled to which location after the revolt?
(a) England (b) Rangoon
(c) Bhutan (d) Nepal

39. Who ruled Ramgarh in Madhya Pradesh during the revolt of 1857?
(a) Rani Avantibai Lodhi
(b) Rani Lakshmibai
(c) Raja Gangadhar Rao
(d) Rani Chennamma

40. Kunwar Singh, a zamindar, belonged to which region?
(a) Meerut (b) Lahore
(c) Central Province (d) Bihar

41. Which leader ruled Ramgarh in Madhya Pradesh during the 1857 revolt?
(a) Rani Lakshmi Bai (b) Raja Gangadhar Rao
(c) Rani Avantibai Lodhi (d) Begum Hazrat Mahal

42. In which year did Bahadur Shah Zafar die?
(a) 1865 (b) 1858
(c) 1862 (d) 1859

43. Who introduced the Ryotwari system in India?
(a) Thomas Munro (b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Alexander Reed (d) Warren Hastings

44. Who sent a telegram to the Commander-in-Chief, highlighting the fear experienced by the British?
(a) Lt. Brijis (b) Lt. Colonel Tyler
(c) Lt. Colonel Neil (d) None of these

45. Who introduced the Doctrine of Lapse?
(a) Lord Dalhousie (b) Lord Canning
(c) William Bentinck (d) Lord Cornwallis

46. Nana Saheb was the adopted son of which ruler?
(a) Baji Rao II (b) Shivaji
(c) Rani Lakshmibai (d) Tipu Sultan

47. In which year did the rule of the East India Company in India come to an end?
(a) 1850 (b) 1859
(c) 1845 (d) 1858

48. Who served as the General of Nana Saheb during the 1857 revolt?
(a) Mangal Pandey (b) Tantia Tope
(c) Kunwar Singh (d) Rani Lakshmi Bai

49. Identify the correct statements about the leaders of the 1857 uprising:
I. Kunwar Singh led the revolt in Bihar.
II. Begum Hazrat Mahal led the revolt in Lucknow.
III. Ahmadullah led the revolt in Faizabad.
IV. Bahadur Shah Zafar was the symbolic leader representing the Mughal throne.
V. Rani Lakshmibai led the revolt in Jhansi.
VI. Nana Saheb led the revolt in Kanpur.
(a) I, II and VI (b) II, IV and VI
(c) I, III, IV and V (d) All of these

MCQ Answer

1-c	2-d	3-a	4-b	5-c
6-c	7-c	8-c	9-d	10-a
11-d	12-c	13-a	14-c	15-a
16-a	17-a	18-c	19-b	20-a
21-c	22-b	23-b	24-b	25-d
26-c	27-d	28-d	29-d	30-d
31-a	32-a	33-c	34-a	35-b
36-a	37-d	38-b	39-a	40-d
41-c	42-c	43-a	44-b	45-a
46-a	47-d	48-b	49-d	

6 Civilising the "Native," Educating the Nation

- **British Rule & Education:** Along with territorial expansion and revenue control, the British in India believed they had a cultural mission—to "civilise the natives" by changing their customs, values, and systems of education.
- **Key Question:** How should Indians be educated to become what the British considered "good subjects"? This led to heated debates and differing policies over the 19th century.

The Tradition of Orientalism:

1. **William Jones (1783):**
   - Arrived in Calcutta as a junior judge at the Supreme Court set up by the East India Company.
   - A polymath and linguist (knew Greek, Latin, French, English, Arabic, Persian, and later studied Sanskrit).
   - Spent hours learning from pandits, diving deep into ancient Indian texts on law, philosophy, religion, arithmetic, medicine, etc.
2. **Asiatic Society & Asiatick Researches:**
   - Jones, along with Henry Thomas Colebrooke and Nathaniel Halhed, formed the Asiatic Society of Bengal, publishing a journal called Asiatick Researches.
   - They believed in respecting ancient Indian cultures but held that India had "declined" from a glorious past.
   - Emphasised rediscovering and translating sacred texts (Sanskrit & Persian) to revitalise Indian tradition.
3. **Orientalist Vision:**
   - Argued the British should support Sanskrit and Persian learning to gain Indian respect.
   - Founded institutions like the Calcutta Madrasa (1781) to promote Arabic & Persian studies and the Benaras Hindu College (1791) to encourage Sanskrit studies.
   - Believed these steps would help the British become guardians of Indian culture as well as its rulers.

Criticisms of Orientalism:

1. **Grave Errors of the East:**
   - By the early 19th century, a group of British officials began to criticise Orientalist approaches.
   - They felt Indian literature was "unscientific," filled with errors, and not useful for India's modern development.
2. **James Mill's View:**
   - Asserted that the British should teach practical, useful subjects like science and technology rather than ancient poetry or sacred literature.
   - Wanted Indians to learn about modern economic and political ideas to strengthen British rule and commerce.
3. **Thomas Babington Macaulay's Minute (1835):**
   - Declared India an "uncivilised" country needing Western knowledge and English education.
   - Famously stated that "one shelf of a good European library was worth the whole native literature of India and Arabia."
   - Urged the government to stop funding Oriental learning, calling it outdated and of little practical value.
   - Emphasised teaching English to uplift and civilise Indians.
4. **The English Education Act (1835):**
   - Based on Macaulay's recommendations.

- Decided that English, instead of Sanskrit or Persian, would be the medium of instruction in higher education.
- Oriental institutions (like Calcutta Madrasa, Benaras Sanskrit College) lost official support and funding.

Education for Commerce: Wood's Despatch (1854)

1. **Charles Wood's Despatch:**
   - In 1854, the Court of Directors in London sent an educational despatch (drafted by Charles Wood) to the Governor-General of India.
   - Reiterated that European learning was essential for India's progress, focusing on practical and commercial benefits.
2. **Objectives:**
   - **Economic Angle:** Western education would make Indians realise the advantages of trade and commerce.
   - **Moral Development:** It would instil discipline, honesty, and loyalty among Indians, creating better clerks and civil servants.
   - **Expanding Demand for British Goods:** Educated Indians would develop Western tastes, thus increasing the market for British products.
3. **Implementation:**
   - Education Departments set up to oversee schools and colleges.
   - Universities established in **Calcutta, Madras, Bombay (1857)** even as the Revolt of 1857 unfolded.
   - Standardised curricula, introduction of textbooks, and new rules for teachers and students.

The Demand for Moral Education:

Missionary Perspective:

- Christian missionaries believed moral improvement came only from Christian education.
- They established missionary schools across India, often preaching religion alongside basic literacy.

Company's Hesitation:

- Initially, the East India Company did not encourage missionary activity out of fear of provoking resistance among Indians.
- After 1857, the British were cautious about directly supporting such schools to avoid hurting Indian sentiments.

What Happened to the Local Schools?

1. **William Adam's Report (1830s):**
   - **Adam's Tour:** The Company sent Adam to survey vernacular education in Bengal & Bihar.

Findings:

- Over **1 lakh pathshalas** educating about **20 lakh** children.
- Typically small, with about 20 pupils each.
- Set up by local communities, wealthy patrons, or initiated by teachers (gurus).
- **Flexible System:** No fixed curriculum, no printed books, no standardised fees, no time-bound attendance.
- Classes often took place under trees, in corners of shops, or in temples.
- Teaching was mostly oral; gurus adapted lessons to each student's need and level.

Advantages:

- Suited to the harvest cycle (schools closed during harvest, letting peasant children help in fields).
- **Affordable:** Fees adjusted to family income, ensuring even poor families could send children.

2. **New Routines, New Rules:**
   - Before 1854, the Company focused on higher education, leaving local pathshalas relatively free.
   - After Wood's Despatch, officials decided to reform vernacular schools:

⇒ Government Pandits appointed to inspect pathshalas, enforce new teaching standards, timetables, textbooks, and annual exams.

⇒ Pathshalas that conformed to these rules received government grants; others risked losing support.

Impact:

- Gurus who valued autonomy found it hard to survive without funds.
- Mandatory attendance clashed with harvest schedules, making it difficult for poor children.
- Traditional flexibility was lost; no attendance was now labelled "indiscipline."

The Agenda for a National Education:

While the British debated how to "civilise natives," many Indian thinkers developed their own views on education:

Western Education & Modernisation:

- Some Indians admired Western scientific achievements and urged the British to open more schools and colleges.
- They believed modern knowledge could revitalise India and help it stand alongside European nations.

Mahatma Gandhi: "English Education Has Enslaved Us"

1. **Critique of Colonial Education:**
   - Claimed it created an inferiority complex in Indians, idolising everything Western and eroding pride in local traditions.
   - Believed it separated Indians from their own culture and "enslaved" their minds.
2. **Medium of Education:**
   - Insisted on Indian languages for instruction to maintain closeness to social and cultural roots.
   - English-based schooling made Indians "strangers in their own land."
3. **Beyond Literacy:**
   - Emphasised that mere reading and writing is not real education; advocated for craft-based learning to develop mind and body.
   - Education should be holistic: physical, intellectual, and spiritual.
4. **National Movement:**
   - Urged students to boycott British institutions to reject foreign dominance and reclaim self-respect.

Rabindranath Tagore: "Abode of Peace"

1. **Personal School Experience:**
   - Found formal schooling in Calcutta suffocating and limiting creativity.
2. **Santiniketan (1901):**
   - Set up in a rural setting, about 100 km from Calcutta.
   - Believed in learning amidst nature to nurture the child's curiosity and creativity.
   - Wanted imaginative teachers who understood each child's individual nature.
3. **Blend of Traditions:**
   - Unlike Gandhiji, Tagore did not reject Western science or technology.
   - Envisioned an educational system combining the best of modern Western ideas with Indian cultural roots.

1. Who were the first to establish schools exclusively for girls' education in India?
   (a) Indian social reformers
   (b) Local government
   (c) British East India Company
   (d) Christian missionaries
2. What major act related to education was introduced in India in 1835?
   (a) Arabic Education Act
   (b) English Education Act
   (c) Civil Services Act
   (d) Sanskrit Education Act
3. Those who have scholarly knowledge of Asian languages and cultures were referred to as:
   (a) Anglicists (b) Munshi
   (c) Orientalists (d) Vernacular
4. What term is used to describe experts in Asiatic languages and cultures?

(a) Orientalists (b) Linguists
(c) Munshis (d) Vernacularists

5. Who introduced Wood's Dispatch, which focused on education for commercial purposes in India?
(a) Charles Wood (b) William Wood
(c) Henry Wood (d) Archie Wood

6. According to Aurobindo Ghosh, what should education inspire in Indian students?
(a) Thoughtfulness (b) Nationality
(c) Integration (d) Religious devotion

7. What did Wood's Dispatch focus on improving among Indian people?
(a) Sophistication (b) Illiteracy
(c) Poverty (d) Moral character

8. Which city, known for its historical significance, is located on the banks of the Hooghly River?
(a) Calcutta (b) Lahore
(c) Madras (d) Delhi

9. What is the title given to someone who can read, write, and teach Persian?
(a) Munshi (b) Qazi
(c) Brahman (d) Maulavi

10. Who made the remark that "a single shelf of a good European library was worth the entire native literature of India and Arabia"?
(a) Babington Macaulay (b) William Jones
(c) James Mill (d) Charles Grant

11. What was one of the key objectives of Wood's Dispatch?
(a) To eliminate illiteracy
(b) To promote moral values
(c) To end poverty
(d) To increase sophistication

12. Thomas Macaulay strongly advocated the teaching of which language?
(a) Sanskrit (b) Persian
(c) English (d) Arabic

13. Who believed that India was an uncivilised society that needed to be civilised?
(a) Thomas Macaulay (b) James Mill
(c) Robert Clive (d) Warren Hastings

14. When was the Hindu College established to promote Hindu religious studies?
(a) 1791 (b) 1799
(c) 1795 (d) 1792

15. Who was the Dutch painter who visited India in the late 18th century and illustrated the everyday life of a village pathshala?
(a) Thomas Daniell
(b) William Hodges
(c) Baltazard Solvyns
(d) Francois Balthazar Solvyns

16. What did Rabindranath Tagore want to combine with traditional Indian education?
(a) Western education (b) Religious education
(c) Local education (d) Eastern education

17. Who founded the Asiatic Society of Bengal?
(a) Nathaniel Halhed
(b) Henry Thomas Colebrooke
(c) William Jones
(d) James Prinsep

18. In 1854, who was appointed to supervise local schools in India?
(a) Government teachers
(b) Government officials
(c) Government pandits
(d) Government servants

19. What activity was the East India Company opposed to in India until 1813?
(a) Missionary activities (b) Education
(c) Religious events (d) Trade

20. Which college was built along the banks of the Hooghly River in Calcutta?
(a) Hindu College (b) Islamic College
(c) Serampore College (d) Scottish College

21. Who established the University of Bombay?
(a) The British (b) The French
(c) The Dutch (d) The Germans

22. Who was the first British official to disagree with the views of Orientalists?
(a) James Mill (b) William Jones
(c) Henry Colebrook (d) Henry Ongle

23. In 1854, the British East India Company appointed several _____ to oversee groups of local schools.
(a) School supervisors (b) Education officers
(c) Government pandits (d) District inspectors

24. According to Adam's report, how many schools were there in rural Bihar and Bengal during the 1830s?
(a) 50,000 (b) 1,00,000
(c) 5,00,000 (d) 2,00,000

25. What was the name of the journal started by William Jones?
(a) Philosophical Research
(b) Asiatick Research
(c) Bengal Gazette
(d) The Times of India

26. Which British official showed great admiration for Indian culture and traditions?
(a) Henry Colebrook (b) James Warren
(c) Bruce Jones (d) Paul Henry

27. Where was a madrasa established in 1861 to promote Islamic law and education?
(a) Calcutta (b) Benaras
(c) Bombay (d) Lucknow

28. Who visited Bihar and Bengal in the 1830s to study vernacular schools and prepare a report?
(a) William Adams (b) Robert Clive
(c) Thomas Bell (d) William Woods

29. In 1783, William Jones arrived in Calcutta to serve as:
(a) A senior magistrate
(b) A legal advisor
(c) A junior judge
(d) A colonial administrator

30. In the 1830s, classes in rural schools were stopped during which season?
(a) Harvest season (b) Summer season
(c) Winter season (d) Rainy season

31. In which year was the English Education Act implemented in India?
(a) 1919 (b) 1835
(c) 1884 (d) 1857

32. Where did the East India Company establish a Hindu College to promote English studies?
(a) Benaras (b) Madras
(c) Surat (d) Lucknow

33. Who was the Scottish missionary who played a key role in establishing the Serampore Mission?
(a) William Carey (b) Paul Derik
(c) James Watt (d) Thomas Woods

34. When was Wood's Dispatch introduced to reform education in India?
(a) 1854 (b) 1855
(c) 1845 (d) 1839

35. Who famously said that English education had enslaved Indians?
(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Raja Rammohan Roy
(c) Rasbehari Bose (d) Sardar Patel

36. Which Scottish missionary toured the districts of Bengal and Bihar during the 1830s?
(a) Charles Grant
(b) William Carey
(c) Thomas Babington Macaulay
(d) William Adam

37. Who founded Shantiniketan in 1901?
(a) Rabindranath Tagore
(b) Subhash Chandra Bose
(c) Aurobindo Ghosh
(d) R C Mukherjee

38. What do we call a person who studies and knows many languages?
(a) Teacher (b) Linguist
(c) Learner (d) Multi-talented

39. Which English official was known for his deep admiration and respect for Indian culture?
(a) William Jones (b) James Mill
(c) Henry Colebrooke (d) Charles Grant

40. Who was one of the first British officials to study Sanskrit in India?
(a) William Jones (b) Robert Clive
(c) John Mills (d) Esther Hills

41. Which type of rural schools were supported by government grants in India?
(a) Pathshalas (b) Temples
(c) Colleges (d) Shops

42. Which scholar translated important works such as Shakuntala and Manusmriti into English?
(a) William Jones (b) James Mill
(c) Charles Wilkins (d) Lord Macaulay

43. Who first introduced schools specifically for girls in India?
(a) Christian Missionaries
(b) Local Government
(c) Indian Pandits
(d) The East India Company

MCQ Answer

1-d	2-b	3-c	4-a	5-a
6-a	7-d	8-a	9-a	10-a
11-a	12-c	13-a	14-a	15-d
16-a	17-c	18-a	19-a	20-a
21-a	22-a	23-c	24-b	25-b
26-a	27-a	28-a	29-c	30-a
31-b	32-a	33-a	34-a	35-a
36-d	37-a	38-b	39-c	40-a
41-a	42-a	43-a		

7 Women, Caste, and Reform

Have you ever wondered how children, especially girls, lived about two hundred years ago? Life was very different then:

- **Child Marriage:** Common among most communities.
- **Restrictions on Women:** Widows faced severe hardships, and practices like sati were prevalent in some regions.
- **No Access to Education:** Very few women received any formal education. Many people believed an educated girl would become a widow.
- **Multiple Marriages:** Hindu and Muslim men could legally marry more than one wife.
- **Caste-Based Discrimination:** People were divided as Brahmans, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, Shudras, and 'untouchables,' with rigid rules about social interaction.

Working Towards Change

1. **The Print Revolution and Debates:**
   - **Spread of Printing:** By the early 19th century, books, newspapers, and pamphlets became cheaper, enabling more people to read and discuss social, political, and economic issues.
   - **Role of Reformers:** Individuals like Raja Rammohun Roy initiated dialogues on unjust social customs. They believed persuading people was key to ending harmful practices.
2. **Raja Rammohun Roy (1772–1833) and the Campaign Against Sati:**
   - Founded the Brahmo Sabha (later Brahmo Samaj) in Calcutta.
   - Wrote extensively on women's plight, argued for women's education and equality.
   - Led a campaign against sati, showing it had no religious sanction in ancient texts.
   - Influenced British officials to ban sati in 1829.

Changing the Lives of Widows:

- **Ishwarchandra Vidyasagar** used **ancient Sanskrit texts** to argue that widows could remarry.
- The **Widow Remarriage Act (1856)** was passed despite strong opposition.
- Reformers like **Veerasalingam Pantulu** in Andhra, **Swami Dayanand Saraswati** (Arya Samaj), and others supported widow remarriage.
- **Social Reality:** Even after the law, **few widows remarried** due to societal pressures.

Girls Begin Going to School:

- **Fear of Public Spaces:** Initially, people worried girls' education would distract them from domestic duties or expose them to "corrupt" influences while traveling to school.
- **Home-Based Learning:** Many families arranged tutors at home or taught daughters secretly (e.g., Rashsundari Debi).

  Efforts of Reformers:

  ⇒ Vidyasagar set up schools for girls in Calcutta.
  ⇒ Jyotirao Phule started schools for girls in Maharashtra.
  ⇒ Arya Samaj opened girls' schools in Punjab.
- **Muslim Women's Education:** In aristocratic households, women learned the **Qur'aan** in Arabic from female tutors. Reformers like **Mumtaz Ali** and novelists writing in Urdu promoted women's education.

Women Write About Women:

1. **Participation of Women in Reform:**
   - **Begums of Bhopal:** Promoted girls' education; opened a primary school in Aligarh.
   - **Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain:** Opened schools in Patna and Calcutta for Muslim girls; questioned conservative ideas in her writings.
2. **New Roles and Writings:**
   - **Women in Universities:** From the 1880s onwards, some women trained to be doctors, teachers, and writers.
   - **Tarabai Shinde (Poona):** Wrote *Stripurushtulna* (A Comparison Between Men and Women), critiquing social inequalities.

   Pandita Ramabai:
   ⇒ A Sanskrit scholar who argued that Hinduism was oppressive to women.
   ⇒ Wrote about upper-caste women's sufferings.
   ⇒ Founded a widows' home at Poona for those treated badly by in-laws.
3. **Reactions and the Child Marriage Restraint Act:**
   - **Orthodox Opposition:** Conservative Hindus and Muslims opposed such reforms, fearing "Westernisation."
   - **Women's Organisations:** Encouraged writing, set up schools, formed political pressure groups.
   - **Child Marriage Restraint Act (1929):** Prohibited marriage below 18 for men and 16 for women (later raised to 21 and 18 respectively).

Caste and Social Reform:

1. **Questioning Caste Inequalities:**
   - **Rammohun Roy** translated a Buddhist text critical of caste.
   - **Prarthana Samaj** in Bombay followed the Bhakti tradition emphasising **spiritual equality.**
   - **Paramhans Mandali (1840):** Worked for **caste abolition** in secret meetings.
2. **"Lower" Castes Moving for Change:**
   - **Missionary Schools:** Began teaching "lower"-caste children.
   - **Urban and Plantation Work:** Low-caste peasants found new opportunities in factories, building roads, railways, moving to cities, or migrating to plantations.
   - **Economic Mobility:** During the First World War, leatherworkers profited from supplying shoes to armies, challenging "polluting" job biases.

Demands for Equality and Justice:

1. **Jyotirao Phule (Gulamgiri):**
   - **Jyotirao Phule (1827–1890):** Educated by Christian missionaries, deeply opposed caste discrimination.
   - Challenged Brahman superiority by arguing they were "Aryan invaders" who subjugated indigenous peoples (Shudras, Ati Shudras).
   - Founded **Satyashodhak Samaj** to propagate caste equality.
   - Wrote *Gulamgiri* (1873), linking the plight of Indian "lower" castes to black slaves in America.
2. **Dr B.R. Ambedkar and Temple Entry Movements:**
   - **B.R. Ambedkar (1891–1956):** Born into a Mahar family, faced **untouchability** in school.
   - After returning from higher studies in the US, he led movements to enter temples where Dalits were forbidden.
   - Fought for equality and dignity, exposing how caste prejudice operated in daily life.
3. **Non-Brahman Movement and Periyar:**

   E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker (Periyar):
   - Originally in the Congress, left after witnessing discriminatory seating at a nationalists' feast.
   - Founded the **Self Respect Movement**, championing Dravidian culture against Brahman domination.
   - Criticised Hindu religious texts like the **Manu Smriti**, *Bhagavad Gita*, and *Ramayana* for justifying caste and patriarchy.

4. Orthodox Responses:
   - Sanatan Dharma Sabhas, Bharat Dharma Mahamandal, and Brahman Sabhas in Bengal tried to uphold caste distinctions.
   - Debates and struggles over caste continued into the post-colonial era.

Organising for Reform: Important Movements:

- The **Aligarh Movement** was led by **Sir Syed Ahmed Khan**, who founded the **Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College in 1875**, which later became **Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)**. The movement aimed to promote modern Western education among Muslims, emphasizing scientific and rational thinking while preserving Islamic values.
- **Prarthana Samaj** was founded by **Atmaram Pandurang** in **1867 in Bombay** (now Mumbai) to promote social reforms such as **widow remarriage, caste equality, abolition of child marriage, and female education.**
- **Arya Samaj** was founded by **Swami Dayanand Saraswati** in **1875** in **Bombay (now Mumbai)** with the aim of reviving Vedic teachings and opposing idol worship.
- **Brahmo Samaj** was founded by **Raja Rammohan Roy** on **August 20, 1828,** in **Calcutta** (now Kolkata) to promote monotheism and oppose social evils such as **Sati and caste discrimination**. It rejected idolatry and drew inspiration from both Hindu and Christian ideals.
- **Veda Samaj** was founded in **1864 in Madras** (now Chennai) by **Keshab Chandra Sen** and **Sridharalu Naidu. Inspired** by the **Brahmo Samaj**, it aimed to promote religious and social reforms, fight superstitions and caste inequality, and advocate for widow remarriage and progressive social changes.
- **Mumtaz Ali** was a 19th-century reformer who **reinterpreted the Qur'an** to **advocate for women's education** and gender equality in Islamic society.
- **Ramakrishna Mission** was founded by **Swami Vivekananda** in **1897** in **Belur, West Bengal,** to spread the teachings of Sri Ramakrishna and engage in humanitarian work.
- **The Widow Remarriage Act, 1856** was passed due to the efforts of **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar,** who strongly advocated for the rights of widows to remarry.
- **Satyashodhak Samaj** was founded by **Jyotirao Phule** in **1873** in **Maharashtra** to fight against caste oppression and promote education for lower castes and women.
- **The Theosophical Society** was **founded in New York in 1875** and established in **India in 1879** by **Madame Blavatsky and Colonel Henry Olcott** to promote spiritual and philosophical studies.
- **Henry Louis Vivian Derozio** founded the **Young Bengal Movement** in the **1820s at Hindu College, Calcutta,** encouraging critical thinking, women's education, and freedom of expression while challenging orthodox traditions.
- **The Sati system was abolished in 1829** due to the efforts of **Raja Rammohan Roy,** with the **support of Lord William Bentinck,** who passed the law making Sati illegal.
- **Veeresalingam Pantulu** led the **widow remarriage movement** in the **Telugu regions** and was one of the pioneers of social reform in South India.
- **Jyotirao Phule** advocated for **caste equality, education for lower castes,** and **women's education,** and also established the **Satyashodhak Samaj** in 1873.
- **Pandita Ramabai** criticized **oppressive practices on women,** actively **promoted women's education,** and founded the **Sharada Sadan** in Pune to support widows and destitute women.
- **Periyar (E.V. Ramasamy Naicker)** strongly opposed **Brahmanical supremacy,** fought against caste discrimination, and founded the **Self-Respect Movement** in **1925** to promote social justice and equality.
- **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar** was a key advocate for **widow remarriage, women's education,** and used **Sanskrit texts** to justify and promote these reforms in Hindu society.

1. Who promoted widow remarriage in the 19th century?
(a) P C Mukherjee
(b) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(c) Narendra Nath Dutt
(d) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee

2. In ancient India, which group included peasants and artisans?
(a) Brahmins (b) Kshatriyas
(c) Vaishyas (d) Shudras

3. Who established the Arya Samaj in India?
(a) Raja Rammohan Roy
(b) Justice Ranade
(c) Swami Dayananda Saraswati
(d) B C Chattopadhyaya

4. Which Governor-General played a key role in the abolition of the Sati system in India?
(a) Lord Cornwallis
(b) Lord Dalhousie
(c) Lord William Bentinck
(d) Lord Wellesley

5. Who is recognized as the "Prophet of Modern India"?
(a) Swami Vivekananda (b) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(c) Jyotiba Phule (d) B. R. Ambedkar

6. Which leader, known as the "Grand Old Man of India," co-founded the Indian National Congress and advocated for women's legal rights?
(a) Dadabhai Naoroji
(b) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(c) Surendranath Banerjee
(d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

7. Which organisation worked to reform Hindu customs?
(a) Arya Samaj
(b) Christian Missionaries
(c) East India Company
(d) Caste System

8. Who wrote the book *Stripurushtulana*?
(a) Begum Rokya Shakhawat Hussain
(b) Ramabai Ranade
(c) Begum Kausar Bi
(d) Tarabai Shinde

9. When was the Aligarh Muslim University founded?
(a) 1875 (b) 1874
(c) 1877 (d) 1872

10. Who was a leading Muslim woman reformer in the 19th century?
(a) Mumtaz Ali (b) Begum Hazrat Mahal
(c) Zinat Mahal (d) Nazma Khatun

11. When was the Child Marriage Restraint Act passed?
(a) 1929 (b) 1940
(c) 1925 (d) 1928

12. Which prominent leader wrote the book 'Gulamgiri'?
(a) Jyotirao Phule
(b) B. R. Ambedkar
(c) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(d) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

13. Who famously said, "Government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth"?
(a) George Washington (b) Thomas Jefferson
(c) Abraham Lincoln (d) Theodore Roosevelt

14. Who wrote the famous book Stripurushtulana?
(a) Tarabai Shinde
(b) Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hussain
(c) Ramabai Ranade
(d) Begum Kausar Bi

15. Who established the first primary school for girls in 1848 in Pune?
(a) Jyotirao Phule (b) Savitribai Phule
(c) Rani Lakshmi Bai (d) Both (a) and (b)

16. Which organisation was founded in Bombay in 1849?
(a) Brahmo Samaj (b) Paramhansa Mandali
(c) Prarthana Samaj (d) Home Rule League

17. Which caste is still considered an upper caste in India?
(a) Harijans (b) Shudras
(c) Kshatriyas (d) Vaishyas

18. Who started a school for girls in Maharashtra?
(a) Jyotiba Phule
(b) Justice Ranade
(c) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(d) A R Iyer

19. Which organization was established in Madras in 1864?
(a) Prarthana Samaj (b) Ved Samaj
(c) Arya Samaj (d) Ramakrishna Mission

20. What did Raja Rammohan Roy try to spread across India?
(a) Western Education (b) Untouchability
(c) Religious Teachings (d) Casteism

21. Which caste traditionally made shoes in Andhra Pradesh?
(a) Madigas (b) Harijans
(c) Kinnars (d) Julahas

22. Who established "The Servants of India Society"?
(a) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) Mahadev Govind Ranade
(d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

23. Who started schools for Muslim girls in Patna?
(a) Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hussain
(b) Begum Shanum
(c) Begum Zinat Mahal
(d) Begum Kausar Bi

24. During which century were the first Urdu novels authored?
(a) 17th century (b) 18th century
(c) 19th century (d) 20th century

25. Where were Indian labourers sent by the British to work on plantations?
(a) Kenya (b) Mauritius
(c) USA (d) China

26. Who set up the Widows' Home in Poona?
(a) Tarabai Shinde (b) Pandita Ramabai
(c) Savitribai Phule (d) Rokeya Hussain

27. Who first opened schools for tribal and lower-caste children?
(a) Christian Missionaries
(b) Brahmo Samaj
(c) Prarthana Sabha
(d) Prerna Samaj

28. Who was the pioneering woman who established schools for Muslim girls in Patna?
(a) Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain
(b) Begum Mumtaz Mahal
(c) Begum Kausar Bi
(d) Begum Zinat Mahal

29. When was the Arya Samaj established?
(a) 1875 (b) 1870
(c) 1876 (d) 1880

30. Who wrote the book *Stree-Purush Tulana*, which was published in 1882?
(a) Pandita Ramabai
(b) Tarabai Shinde
(c) Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain
(d) Sarojini Naidu

31. What do Brahmins and Kshatriyas often consider themselves?
(a) Educationists (b) Upper Caste
(c) Government Officials (d) Lower Caste

32. What is the meaning of the term "Monotheism"?
(a) Worship of multiple gods
(b) Worship of nature
(c) Belief in one God
(d) Worship of ancestors

33. To which caste did Dr. B R Ambedkar belong?
(a) Mahar (b) Dubla
(c) Gond (d) Brahman

34. Where are the people of the Dubla caste primarily from?
(a) Gujarat (b) Odisha
(c) Arunachal Pradesh (d) Delhi

35. Which group was often treated as untouchables in society?
(a) Teachers (b) Traders
(c) Shudras (d) Brahmans

36. Who founded the Brahmo Samaj?
(a) Swami Vivekananda (b) Raja Rammohan Roy
(c) Ravindranath Tagore (d) M C Mukherjee

37. When was the practice of Sati officially banned?
(a) 1829 (b) 1833
(c) 1822 (d) 1845

38. Who challenged religious texts that supported the caste system?
(a) Ghasidas (b) Patel
(c) Haridas Thakur (d) Narayan Swami

39. Who authored the book 'Satyarth Prakash'?
(a) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(b) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(c) Swami Vivekananda
(d) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

40. Who was the leader of the Self-Respect Movement?
(a) Periyar (b) Raja Rammohan Roy
(c) Ambedkar (d) Jyotiba Phule

41. Which organisation was founded by Jyotiba Phule?
(a) Satyashodhak Samaj (b) Prarthana Sabha
(c) Brahmo Samaj (d) Widow School

42. When was the Paramhansa Mandali founded?
(a) 1843 (b) 1842
(c) 1845 (d) 1840

43. Who belonged to the Ezhava caste?
(a) Ambedkar (b) Sri Narayana Guru
(c) Haridas Thakur (d) Srinath Guru

44. When did the American Revolution commence?
(a) 1765 (b) 1775
(c) 1783 (d) 1791

45. Jyotiba Phule studied in a school established by whom?
(a) Ghasidas
(b) Indian Reformists
(c) Christian Missionaries
(d) Religious Groups

46. Which institution in Amritsar was established by the Singh Sabha Movement?
(a) Hindu College (b) Nanak College
(c) Lahore College (d) Khalsa College

47. Which sect did Haridas Thakur belong to?
(a) Matua (b) Dubla

(c) Gond (d) Bhil

48. Who led the Satnami Movement?
(a) Mahardas (b) Ghasidas
(c) Ambedkar (d) P C Roy

49. On which plantations in America did African slaves work?
(a) Coffee (b) Rice
(c) Cotton (d) Potato

50. Who led the Aligarh Movement?
(a) Sir Sayyid Ahmed Khan
(b) Akbar Ali Khan
(c) Rahmat Pathan
(d) Swami Vivekananda

51. Which college in Amritsar was established by the Singh Sabha Movement?
(a) Khalsa College (b) Hindu College
(c) DAV College (d) Lahore College

52. Which organisation was established in Bombay in 1867?
(a) Brahmo Mandali
(b) Prarthana Samaj
(c) Paramhansa Mandali
(d) Brahmo Samaj

53. Who was referred to as the "Vidyasagar of the South"?
(a) M. Visvesvaraya
(b) R. Gopalakrishnan
(c) Narayana Guru
(d) Kandukuri Veeresalingam Pantulu

54. What is the title of the book written by Jyotiba Phule?
(a) Harijans of India (b) Stripurushtulana
(c) Gulamgiri (d) Abhyas

55. Who founded the Ramakrishna Mission?
(a) Swami Vivekananda
(b) Swami Haridas
(c) Bhagini Nivedita
(d) Swami Harinanda

56. Which organisation was established in Madras in 1867?
(a) Sikh Samaj
(b) Ved Samaj
(c) Ramakrishna Mission
(d) Prarthana Sabha

57. Which movement was founded by Henry Derozio?
(a) Aligarh Movement
(b) Brahmo Samaj
(c) Social Reform Movement
(d) Young Bengal Movement

58. Who spearheaded the movement for temple entry reform?
(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Jyotirao Phule (d) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

59. What were women called who burned themselves on their husbands' funeral pyres?
(a) Devi (b) Sati
(c) Suhagan (d) Mata

60. Who started the Young Bengal Movement?
(a) Rahmat Pathan
(b) Henry Derozio
(c) Sir Sayyid Ahmed Khan
(d) Swami Vivekananda

MCQ Answer

1-b	2-d	3-c	4-c	5-b
6-a	7-a	8-d	9-a	10-a
11-a	12-a	13-c	14-a	15-d
16-b	17-c	18-a	19-b	20-a
21-a	22-a	23-a	24-c	25-b
26-b	27-a	28-a	29-a	30-b
31-b	32-c	33-a	34-a	35-c
36-b	37-a	38-a	39-a	40-a
41-a	42-a	43-b	44-b	45-c
46-d	47-a	48-b	49-c	50-a
51-a	52-b	53-d	54-c	55-a
56-b	57-d	58-b	59-b	60-b

THE CONCEPTUM

8 The Making of the National Movement: 1870s–1947

The Emergence of Nationalism:

Nationalism is the sense that a country belongs to all its people equally, and should be governed in their interests. In India's context, the growing realisation was that British policies served British interests rather than Indian ones.

1. **Early Political Associations:**
   - Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Indian Association, Madras Mahajan Sabha, Bombay Presidency Association, and later the Indian National Congress (1885).
   - Many were formed or led by English-educated professionals (lawyers, journalists).
   - The term Sarvajanik means "for all the people," reflecting the idea that India belonged to all its inhabitants.
2. **Rising Discontent and Key Laws:**
   - **Arms Act (1878):** Indians were prohibited from owning arms freely, displaying British mistrust.
   - **Vernacular Press Act (1878):** Curbed freedom of the Indian press by allowing the government to confiscate printing presses if publications were deemed "objectionable."
   - **Ilbert Bill Controversy (1883):** Sought equality between Indian and European judges, but strong white opposition forced its withdrawal, exposing British racial bias.
3. **Founding of the Indian National Congress (1885):**
   - 72 delegates from different parts of India met in Bombay in December 1885.
   - Dadabhai Naoroji, Pherozeshah Mehta, W.C. Bonnerji, Surendranath Banerji, Romesh Chandra Dutt, Badruddin Tyabji, and S. Subramania Iyer were key figures.
   - A.O. Hume, a retired British official, helped Indians come together.

Congress in the First Twenty Years: "Moderates"

- Sought greater Indian representation in government and administration, demanded representative Legislative Councils, Indianisation of higher posts, civil service exams in India, and an end to racial discrimination.
- Economic demands included lower land revenue, cutting military expenditure, and reducing salt tax.

Methods of the Moderates:

- Petitions and memorandums
- Public speeches and articles in newspapers
- Believed in British sense of justice and hoped their demands would be accepted if voiced strongly.

Rise of Radical Nationalists:

- By the 1890s, some Indian leaders were frustrated with the "politics of prayers."
- Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Lala Lajpat Rai urged self-reliance (swaraj). Tilak's slogan: "Freedom is my birthright and I shall have it!"

1. **Partition of Bengal (1905) and Swadeshi Movement:**
   - Viceroy Curzon partitioned Bengal, claiming administrative ease but intending to reduce Bengali influence and split them.
   - Triggered mass protests: Swadeshi and Boycott movements.
   - Swadeshi emphasised Indian industries, education, languages, and self-help.
   - Some groups also considered revolutionary violence.

2. **Formation of the Muslim League (1906):**
   - Founded by Muslim landlords and nawabs in Dacca (Dhaka).
   - Supported partition of Bengal and demanded separate electorates (granted in 1909), leading politicians to focus on communal appeals.
3. **Congress Split (1907):**
   - Moderates disliked boycott methods. Radicals parted ways for a while.
   - They reunited in 1915, leading to Congress-League Lucknow Pact (1916), working together for self-government.

Growth of Mass Nationalism after 1919:

Involvement of peasants, tribals, students, women, and eventually some business groups:

1. **Impact of the First World War (1914–18):**
   - Huge defence expenditure, increased taxes (on incomes and profits), high prices hitting the common people.
   - Indian business benefited from fewer imports and increased demand for war supplies, leading to calls for more development opportunities.
   - Forced recruitment of Indian soldiers for a distant war created resentment.
   - The 1917 Russian Revolution inspired ideas of socialism among Indian nationalists.
2. **Mahatma Gandhi's Emergence:**
   - Returned from South Africa in 1915 as a well-known leader of non-violent struggles.
   - Toured India to understand its conditions.
   - Engaged in local protests in Champaran (Bihar), Kheda (Gujarat), and Ahmedabad.

The Rowlatt Act and the Satyagraha (1919):

- Rowlatt Act curbed civil liberties and allowed detention without trial.
- Nationwide satyagraha called by Gandhiji on 6 April 1919.
- Brutal suppression: culminated in Jallianwala Bagh massacre (13 April 1919).
- Rabindranath Tagore renounced his knighthood in protest.

Khilafat Agitation and Non-Cooperation (1920–22)

- Harsh treaty terms on the Turkish Sultan (Khalifa) upset Indian Muslims.
- Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali launched Khilafat agitation.
- Gandhiji supported, linking Khilafat wrong, Punjab wrong, and Swaraj demands.

Non-Cooperation included:

⇒ **Boycotts** of schools, colleges, and law courts.
⇒ **Resigning** from government service.
⇒ **Bonfires** of foreign cloth.

- Foreign cloth imports fell significantly (1920–22).
- Massive participation of students, lawyers (e.g., Motilal Nehru, C.R. Das), and ordinary people.

People's Initiatives:

- **Kheda (Gujarat):** Patidar peasants refused to pay high revenue.
- **Coastal Andhra & Tamil Nadu:** Liquor shops picketed.
- **Guntur (AP):** Tribals did "forest satyagrahas" against forest restrictions.
- **Sindh:** Muslim traders and peasants mobilised under Khilafat call.
- **Punjab:** Akali agitation to remove British-backed mahants from Sikh gurdwaras.
- **Assam:** Tea garden workers demanded higher wages, left plantations chanting "Gandhi Maharaj ki Jai."

The 1922–1929 Developments:

- Non-Cooperation was abruptly withdrawn after the **Chauri Chaura** incident (1922), where protesters killed 22 policemen.
- Gandhians shifted to **constructive work** in villages.

- Other leaders like **C.R. Das** and **Motilal Nehru** favoured contesting elections to councils.
- **Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)** and the **Communist Party of India** founded in the mid-1920s.
- **Bhagat Singh** and other revolutionary nationalists formed the **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)** in 1928.
- They waged **revolutionary actions**, including the assassination of **Saunders** in Lahore (1928) and bombing the Central Legislative Assembly (1929).
- **Congress** resolved to fight for **Purna Swaraj** (complete independence) in **1929** under **Jawaharlal Nehru. 26 January 1930** was observed as "**Independence Day.**"

Civil Disobedience: The Salt March (1930):

- **Gandhiji** announced a march from **Sabarmati** to **Dandi** (~240 miles) to **break the salt law** (the British monopoly on salt).
- Involving **rich and poor**, salt was a unifying issue.
- After reaching Dandi, Gandhi broke the law by **collecting natural salt.**
- **Women, peasants, tribals** joined in large numbers. Business groups, notably, supported to an extent.
- Government responded with **arrests** and **brutal repression.**

Impact of Civil Disobedience:

⇒ Economic and administrative pressures forced British concessions.

⇒ **Government of India Act (1935)** introduced **provincial autonomy.** Elections in **1937** saw Congress form ministries in **7 out of 11** provinces.

Towards Independence:

1. **Outbreak of WWII (1939):**
   - Congress ministries resigned in protest after the British refused to promise freedom post-war.
   - **Subhas Chandra Bose** formed the **Indian National Army (INA).** INA attempted to enter India via **Imphal-Kohima** in 1944, but failed. The captured INA soldiers' trial sparked huge public sympathy.
2. **Quit India Movement (1942):**
   - Gandhiji gave the slogan: "**Quit India**" and "**do or die**" in a non-violent manner.
   - Major repression followed, but the movement spread. Over **90,000** arrested.
   - By **1943**, the British government was severely challenged."

Towards Partition:

1. **Muslim League's Demands:**
   - In **1940**, the League passed a resolution for "**Independent States**" in Muslim-majority areas (though not explicit about Partition).
   - Driven by fear of being a minority in a democratic India, the League emphasised a **separate nation.**
2. **Elections (1946):**
   - Congress won general constituencies; League dominated Muslim seats.
   - **League demanded Pakistan.** British Cabinet Mission's plan for a **united India** with autonomy to Muslim-majority provinces failed to secure agreement.
   - **Direct Action Day** (16 August 1946) saw communal riots in Calcutta. Violence spread, especially in northern India.
3. **Independence and Partition (1947):**
   - India's independence came with **Partition.** Communal violence, mass **refugee** crises, and unprecedented brutality left deep scars.
   - Two nations: **India** and **Pakistan** were born.

1. Where did the Indian National Congress split during its session?
(a) Surat (b) Kolkata
(c) Lahore (d) Nagpur

2. Identify the person who said, "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it."
(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) Subhas Chandra Bose

3. Who was the Indian publicist and businessman based in London?
(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) Lala Hadayal (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

4. Who founded the Indian National Congress in England?
(a) Robert Clive (b) A O Hume
(c) Esther Hill (d) Chris Paul

5. What are the religious functionaries of Sikh Gurdwaras called?
(a) Pandits (b) Peers
(c) Brahmans (d) Mahants

6. Who became the first Muslim President of the Indian National Congress?
(a) Abul Kalam Azad (b) Badruddin Tyabji
(c) Rahmat Shaikh (d) Badshah Khan

7. Which bill allowed Indian judges to try Europeans?
(a) Ilbert Bill (b) Vernacular Press Act
(c) Judiciary Bill (d) Arms Bill

8. Who is known as the "Nightingale of India"?
(a) Annie Besant (b) Sarojini Naidu
(c) Rani Lakshmibai (d) Vijaya L. Pandit

9. Who was responsible for throwing a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly on April 8, 1929?
(a) Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt
(b) Chandrashekhar Azad and Rajguru
(c) Sukhdev and Udham Singh
(d) Subhas Chandra Bose and Jatin Das

10. Who renounced his knighthood following the Jallianwala Bagh massacre?
(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Rabindranath Tagore
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

11. From which city did the 1857 Revolt begin?
(a) Delhi (b) Calcutta
(c) Meerut (d) Kanpur

12. What was the movement called against the Partition of Bengal?
(a) Salt Movement (b) Quit India Movement
(c) Swadeshi Movement (d) Khilafat Movement

13. Which Marathi newspaper was edited by Bal Gangadhar Tilak?
(a) Kesari (b) Sakal
(c) Muktangan (d) Gazette

14. What is the name of the book written by Dadabhai Naoroji?
(a) My Experiments with Truth
(b) Poverty and Un-British Rule in India
(c) Stripurushtulana
(d) Slavery

15. Which social reform group was Lala Lajpat Rai a member of?
(a) Brahmo Samaj (b) Ved Samaj
(c) Arya Samaj (d) Prarthana Samaj

16. When did the Quit India Movement take place?
(a) 1939 (b) 1942
(c) 1940 (d) 1949

17. Who was the first President of the Indian National Congress?
(a) Dadabhai Naoroji
(b) Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee
(c) Surendranath Banerjee
(d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

18. Which act was referred to as the "Black Bill" by Gandhiji?
(a) Rowlatt Act, 1919
(b) Government of India Act, 1935
(c) Vernacular Press Act, 1878
(d) Regulating Act, 1773

19. In which year was the Government of India Act passed?
(a) 1935 (b) 1934
(c) 1932 (d) 1938

20. Which act was passed in 1878?
(a) Vernacular Press Act (b) Indian Education Act
(c) Indian Contract Act (d) Sati Act

21. From which country did Gandhiji return to India in 1915?
(a) Japan (b) South Africa
(c) USA (d) China

22. Who supported the Partition of Bengal?
(a) Communist Party (b) Swaraj Party
(c) Muslim League (d) Congress

23. When was the Arms Act passed?
(a) 1880 (b) 1878
(c) 1875 (d) 1876

24. In which year did Gandhiji lead the mill workers' strike in Ahmedabad?
(a) 1900 (b) 1910
(c) 1922 (d) 1918

25. Which was Gandhiji's first successful movement in

India?
(a) Quit India Movement
(b) Champaran Movement
(c) Natal Movement
(d) Punjab Movement

26. The Vandemataram Movement happened in which region?
(a) Deltaic Andhra (b) Konkan region
(c) Kashmir (d) Coastal Kerala

27. Which Congress leader from Bengal supported radical objectives?
(a) Ravindranath Tagore (b) Bipin Chandra Pal
(c) R C Mukherjee (d) Raja Rammohan Roy

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(c) B. R. Ambedkar (d) Mahatma Gandhi

29. Which act was introduced in 1919?
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(c) Simon Act (d) Vernacular Press Act

30. Who was the Viceroy of India during the Partition of Bengal?
(a) Lord Curzon (b) Lord Clive
(c) Lord Minto (d) Lord Hastings

31. The Khilafat Movement was initiated by which leaders?
(a) Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Ali Brothers – Shaukat Ali and Mohammad Ali
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Lala Lajpat Rai
(d) Subhas Chandra Bose and Sardar Patel

32. Who returned his knighthood after the Jallianwala Bagh massacre?
(a) R C Mukherjee (b) Ravindranath Tagore
(c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) Lala Lajpat Rai

33. Who gave the slogan "Freedom is our birthright"?
(a) Mahatma Gandhi
(b) Lala Lajpat Rai
(c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(d) Laxmi Sehgal

34. Who convinced Mahatma Gandhi to involve women in the freedom movement?
(a) Ambabai (b) Kamala Nehru
(c) Sarojini Naidu (d) Vijaya L. Pandit

35. Which leader was prominent in the Khilafat Movement?
(a) Mohammad Ali (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Badshah Khan (d) Indira Gandhi

36. Which party signed the Lucknow Pact with the Muslim League in 1916?
(a) Congress (b) Socialist Party
(c) British Empire (d) Communist Party

37. Who quit his law practice during the Non-Cooperation Movement?
(a) Shaukat Ali (b) C Rajagopalachari
(c) Sarojini Naidu (d) M A Jinnah

38. In which year was the Partition of Bengal declared?
(a) 1909 (b) 1905
(c) 1902 (d) 1907

39. Where was the All India Muslim League established in 1906?
(a) Lahore (b) Dacca
(c) Poona (d) Peshawar

40. In which year did the Jallianwala Bagh massacre happen?
(a) 1924 (b) 1919
(c) 1917 (d) 1921

41. From the list of leaders below, identify who was not part of the trio "Lal-Bal-Pal."
(a) Lala Lajpat Rai
(b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Bipin Chandra Pal
(d) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

42. Why did the British government's defence expenditure increase in 1919?
(a) Bengal famine
(b) Himalayan earthquake
(c) 1st World War
(d) Japan War

43. Who served as the first Indian Governor-General of free India?
(a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(b) C. Rajagopalachari
(c) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(d) Jawaharlal Nehru

44. When did Gandhiji lead the mill workers' strike in Ahmedabad?
(a) 1918 (b) 1919
(c) 1915 (d) 1922

45. Who headed the Simon Commission in 1927?
(a) Sir John Simon (b) Lord Irwin
(c) Lord Reading (d) Lord Mountbatten

46. What is the honour given by the British Crown for exceptional public service?
(a) Nobel Prize (b) Knighthood
(c) Shikhar Samman (d) Leeds Prize

47. Which organisation did Gandhiji establish in South Africa?
(a) Labour Union (b) Sabarmati Ashram
(c) Natal Congress (d) Communist Party

48. Who is credited with giving the title "Father of the Nation" to Mahatma Gandhi?
(a) Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose
(c) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(d) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

49. The Forest Satyagraha was led by peasants and tribals in which Andhra district?
(a) Hyderabad (b) Kakatiya
(c) Guntur (d) Saleh

50. Identify the lawyer and freedom fighter from East Bengal.
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(a) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
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55. Which major movement was launched in 1930?
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(b) Civil Disobedience Movement
(c) Khilafat Movement
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(a) Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Muhammad Iqbal
(c) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
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(a) Violence in Ahmedabad
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(c) Protest in Bithur
(d) Protest in Cawnpur

64. Where was Maulana Abul Kalam Azad born?
(a) Kolkata, India (b) Mecca, Saudi Arabia
(c) Hyderabad, India (d) Lucknow, India

65. Why did Congress support the British during the 1st World War?
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(b) Gandhi-Irwin Pact
(c) Dandi March
(d) Round Table Conference

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(c) Indira Gandhi
(d) Subhash Chandra Bose

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(a) 1925 (b) 1926
(c) 1924 (d) 1922

69. Which policy was implemented by the British under the "Divide and Rule" strategy?
(a) Pitt's India Act, 1784
(b) Partition of Bengal, 1905
(c) Regulating Act, 1773
(d) Doctrine of Lapse

70. Which organisation did Jinnah reorganise after 1934?
(a) Communist Party (b) Forward Bloc
(c) Muslim League (d) Swatantra Party

71. Who was the British Prime Minister when India gained independence?
(a) Winston Churchill (b) Clement Attlee
(c) Harold Macmillan (d) Neville Chamberlain

72. Who founded Khudai Khidmatgars?
(a) S C Bose
(b) Khan Abdul Gaffar Khan
(c) Liaquat Ali Khan
(d) Maulana Azad

73. Who established the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA) in 1928?
(a) Bhagat Singh
(b) Chandrashekhar Azad
(c) Sukhdev Thapar
(d) Rajguru

74. Who was the first woman president of the Indian National Congress?
(a) Annie Besant (b) Sarojini Naidu
(c) Laxmi Sehgal (d) Ambabai

75. Gandhiji called for which movement after the Civil Disobedience Movement?
(a) Non-Cooperation Movement
(b) Quit India Movement
(c) Swadeshi Movement
(d) Khilafat Movement

76. Who symbolised Hindu-Muslim unity until 1920?
(a) Dara Shikoh (b) M A Jinnah
(c) Badshah Khan (d) Maulana Azad

77. The Partition of Bengal in 1905 resulted in:
(a) Divided into Hindu-majority West Bengal and Muslim-majority East Bengal
(b) Split into Upper Bengal and Lower Bengal
(c) Separated from British India and made a princely state
(d) Divided on the basis of administrative convenience

78. Which organisation was formed by Subhash Chandra Bose?
(a) Judicial Movement
(b) Swarajya Party
(c) Indian National Army
(d) Army Regiment

79. Choose the correct statements?
I. The Ilbert Bill was introduced in India in the year 1883 AD.
II. The Arms Act was passed by the British in the year 1878 AD.
III. The Partition of Bengal took place in the year 1905 AD.
IV. The Muslim League was formed in the year 1906 AD.
V. The first session of the Indian National Congress was held on 28-31 December 1885 in Bombay
VI. The Muslim League announced "Direct Action Day" on 16 August 1946 to demand the creation of Pakistan.
(a) All of these (b) I, II and V
(c) I, II, V and VI (d) I, III, IV and VI

MCQ Answer

1-a	2-b	3-b	4-b	5-d
6-b	7-a	8-b	9-a	10-b
11-c	12-c	13-a	14-b	15-c
16-b	17-b	18-a	19-a	20-a
21-b	22-c	23-b	24-d	25-b
26-a	27-b	28-a	29-b	30-a
31-b	32-b	33-c	34-c	35-a
36-a	37-b	38-b	39-b	40-b
41-d	42-c	43-b	44-a	45-a
46-b	47-c	48-b	49-c	50-c
51-b	52-b	53-b	54-c	55-b
56-b	57-a	58-b	59-c	60-b
61-c	62-d	63-b	64-b	65-a
66-b	67-b	68-a	69-b	70-c
71-b	72-b	73-a	74-a	75-b
76-b	77-a	78-c	79-a	

09 India After Independence

A New and Divided Nation

1. **Independence & Partition (1947):**
   - India gained freedom on **15 August 1947**, but was soon confronted with enormous challenges.
   - **Partition** created two nations: **India** and **Pakistan**, accompanied by large-scale communal violence and over 1 million deaths.
   - **Refugee Crisis:** Approximately **8 million refugees** entered India from Pakistan, needing shelter and employment.
   - **Princely States:** Around **500 princely states**, each ruled by a maharaja or a nawab, had to be integrated into the Union of India, often via negotiations or the use of force.
2. **Unity and Development:**
   - The country was **socially diverse**, with **caste divisions**, religious minorities (Hindus, Muslims, Sikhs, Christians, Jains, Parsis), multiple languages, and varied cultures."Poverty and Rural Life: Most Indians were rural dwellers, dependent on monsoon-based agriculture. Famines and poor living conditions were common."Economic Aspirations: The nation had to modernise agriculture, promote industries, and reduce inequalities while maintaining unity.

A Constitution is Written:

1. **Constituent Assembly (1946-1949):**
   - About **300 members** debated India's political future.
   - Their discussions led to the **adoption of the Constitution on 26 January 1950.**
2. **Key Features:**
   - **Universal Adult Franchise:**

   ⇒ All citizens **21 years** and **older** could vote (later changed to 18 years).

   ⇒ Revolutionary because many Western democracies had granted suffrage in stages (property-owning men, then all men, then women).
   - **Equality Before the Law:**

   ⇒ No discrimination based on **religion, caste,** or **gender.**

   ⇒ India chose to be a **secular** state, granting equal rights to all communities.
   - **Special Privileges for the Disadvantaged:**

   ⇒ Untouchability was abolished; Dalits (formerly "Untouchables") were given reservations in legislatures and government jobs, as were **adivasis** (Scheduled Tribes).

   ⇒ The aim was to counter historic oppression and promote social justice.
   - **Federal Structure with Three Lists:**

   ⇒ **Union List** (e.g., defence, foreign affairs, taxes) under central government.

   ⇒ **State List** (e.g., education, health) under state governments.

   ⇒ **Concurrent List** (e.g., forests, agriculture) shared by Centre and states.
   - **Language Debate:**

   ⇒ Hindi was declared "official language," but **English** remained for courts, administration, inter-state communication.

   ⇒ Compromise to avoid alienating non-Hindi-speaking regions.

3. **Role of Dr B.R. Ambedkar:**
   - Chaired the **Drafting Committee** of the Constitution.
   - Emphasised that **political democracy** (one person, one vote) must be accompanied by **social and economic democracy** to overcome inequalities.

How Were States to be Formed?

1. **Promise of Linguistic States:**
   - During the freedom struggle, the Indian National Congress promised separate provinces for major linguistic groups.
   - Post-independence, leaders like Jawaharlal Nehru and Vallabhbhai Patel feared further splits after Partition, so they hesitated to create states purely on linguistic lines.
2. **Andhra Movement (1952):**
   - Potti Sriramulu, a Gandhian, died after a 58-day fast demanding a separate Telugu-speaking state.
   - Sparked intense agitation, forcing the government to create Andhra (later Andhra Pradesh) in 1953.
3. **States Reorganisation Commission (1956):**
   - Recommended redrawing state boundaries based on languages, leading to states for Assamese, Bengali, Oriya, Tamil, Malayalam, Kannada, Telugu speakers, etc.
   - Bombay was divided into Maharashtra and Gujarat (1960).
   - Punjab was split into Punjab and Haryana (1966).

Planning for Development:

1. **Post-Independence Vision:**
   - Eradicate poverty, modernise agriculture, build industries, generate employment, and reduce inequalities.
2. **Planning Commission (1950):**
   - Tasked with framing Five Year Plans to coordinate and guide economic policies.
   - Embraced a "mixed economy" model – state-owned enterprises (public sector) coexisting with private sector growth.
3. **Second Five Year Plan (1956-1961):**
   - Focused on heavy industries (steel, heavy machinery) and building large dams for irrigation and power.
   - Emphasis on state-led industrialisation; critics argued it neglected agriculture and primary education.
4. **Nehru's Stance:**
   - Emphasised the "temples of modern India" (dams, factories), believing in a strong role for government in industrialising and reducing poverty.
   - Critics like Mira Behn warned about ecological damage and over-reliance on heavy machinery.

An Independent Foreign Policy:

1. **Context:**
   - India's independence coincided with the start of the **Cold War** between the **USA** and the **USSR**, each forming alliances.
2. **Non-Alignment:**
   - Pioneered by **Jawaharlal Nehru** and leaders of other newly independent nations (Egypt, Yugoslavia, Ghana, Indonesia).
   - Urged countries not to align with either the US or Soviet blocs, but to remain active in **peace efforts** and maintain **sovereignty**.
3. **Practical Challenges:**
   - Though "non-aligned," many such nations, including India, got entangled in regional conflicts.
   - By the 1970s, more states joined the **Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)**.

The Nation, Sixty Years On:

1. **Achievements:**
   - **Unity and Democracy:** India remained united despite linguistic, religious, and ethnic diversity. It held **thirteen general elections** by 2007 (many more since then) and maintained **free press** and **independent judiciary.**
   - **Survival as a Republic:** No military dictatorship; multiple parties, peaceful transitions of power.
2. **Ongoing Challenges:**

   Social Inequalities:

   ⇒ Dalits continue facing discrimination and violence in some regions.

   ⇒ Religious minorities sometimes experience communal tensions.

   Economic Inequalities:

   ⇒ Wide gap between the rich (affording luxurious lifestyles) and the poor (living in slums or remote villages).

   ⇒ Many remain below poverty line, lacking access to health, education, and secure livelihoods.
3. **Mixed Results:**
   - India has not fully realised the social and economic equality envisioned in 1950, yet it has safeguarded democracy and national unity to a large extent.

1. Who was India's first Prime Minister?
   (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Jawaharlal Nehru
   (c) Mahatma Gandhi (d) S C Bose
2. Who is known as the Father of the Indian Constitution?
   (a) S C Mukherjee (b) Rajendra Prasad
   (c) Lala Lajpat Rai (d) B R Ambedkar
3. "Operation Blackboard" was a recommendation of which policy?
   (a) NPE 1986
   (b) NPE 1968
   (c) Mudaliar Commission
   (d) Kothari Commission
4. Which education commission recommended the 10+2+3 structure of education in India?
   (a) Radhakrishnan Commission
   (b) Mudaliar Commission
   (c) Kothari Commission
   (d) National Policy on Education 1986
5. What is the official language of India?
   (a) Hindi (b) English
   (c) Sanskrit (d) Urdu
6. Who introduced the Non-Alignment Policy in India?
   (a) Rajendra Prasad (b) Marshal Tito
   (c) K B Iyer (d) Jawaharlal Nehru
7. Under which list are subjects like taxes and defence included?
   (a) Concurrent List (b) Union List
   (c) Princely List (d) State List
8. In which year did education become a fundamental right in India?
   (a) 2012 (b) 2007
   (c) 2009 (d) 2016
9. In which year was the Planning Commission replaced by NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)?
   (a) 10 January 2012 (b) 1 January 2014
   (c) 1 January 2015 (d) 10 January 2016
10. In which year did the Indian Constitution come into effect?
    (a) 1947 (b) 1948
    (c) 1949 (d) 1950
11. Which state was formed on 1 October 1953?
    (a) Gujarat (b) Uttar Pradesh
    (c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Maharashtra
12. In 1930, Bombay was divided into Gujarat and which state?
    (a) Karnataka (b) Maharashtra
    (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Madras
13. Who opposed the imposition of Hindi in South India?
    (a) T T Krishnamachari (b) Sarojini Naidu
    (c) S P Mukherjee (d) C Rajaji
14. What is the full form of NAM?
    (a) Non-Aligned Movement
    (b) National Agreement Mission
    (c) Non-Aggression Movement
    (d) New Age Mission
15. What was the old name of Karnataka?
    (a) Hyderabad (b) Central Province
    (c) United Province (d) Mysore
16. The Indian Constitution was officially adopted on November 26, 1949. On which date did it come into effect?

(a) August 15, 1947 (b) January 26, 1950
(c) November 26, 1950 (d) January 1, 1950

17. On which date is Martyrs' Day (Shaheed Diwas or Sarvodaya Day) observed in India to honor those who sacrificed their lives for the country, especially marking the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi?
(a) August 15 (b) January 30
(c) March 23 (d) October 2

18. When was the Planning Commission established in India?
(a) 1953 (b) 1947
(c) 1952 (d) 1950

19. In which year was the Kothari Commission launched?
(a) 1960 (b) 1964
(c) 1966 (d) 1972

20. What was India's population at the time of independence in 1947?
(a) 345 million (b) 400 million
(c) 322 million (d) 350 million

21. How many lists of subjects are mentioned in the Indian Constitution?
(a) Two (b) Three
(c) Four (d) Five

22. What was introduced in 1956 as part of India's economic planning?
(a) Second Five Year Plan
(b) Planning Commission
(c) Agriculture Commission
(d) Finance Commission

23. Where is Dharavi, one of the largest slums in the world, located?
(a) Madras (b) Delhi
(c) Dacca (d) Mumbai

24. What does UNO stand for?
(a) United Nations Organization
(b) Universal Nations Organization
(c) Union of Nations Overseas
(d) United Nations Office

25. What does NPE stand for in Indian education policy?
(a) National Policy on Education
(b) National English Policy
(c) National Economic Policy
(d) National Programme for Education

26. Which river flows through Madhya Pradesh?
(a) Alaknanda (b) Chambal
(c) Ganga (d) Godavari

27. Who was the Chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution?
(a) S C Sinha (b) T T Krishnamachari
(c) B R Ambedkar (d) Rajendra Prasad

28. In which state is the Bhilai Steel Plant located?
(a) Odisha (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Bihar (d) Chhattisgarh

29. Maharaja Hari Singh ruled which region that had a majority of Muslim population?
(a) Hyderabad (b) Junagadh
(c) Jammu and Kashmir (d) Manipur

30. Which of the following matches is correct?
(a) Union List – defense, foreign affairs, railways
(b) State List – police, public health, agriculture
(c) Concurrent List – education, criminal law, marriage
(d) All of these

31. What type of economy does India have?
(a) Socialist Economy (b) Capitalist Economy
(c) Mixed Economy (d) Traditional Economy

32. Who was the President of the Constituent Assembly of India in 1946?
(a) Dr. Rajendra Prasad (b) B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Sardar Patel (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

33. With whose assistance was the Bhilai Steel Plant set up in 1959?
(a) Britain (b) Burma
(c) Soviet Union (d) USA

34. Mahatma Gandhi was assassinated by Hindu extremist Nathuram Godse on which date?
(a) January 26, 1948 (b) January 30, 1948
(c) February 14, 1948 (d) August 15, 1948

35. Who was the first Deputy Prime Minister of India?
(a) Sardar V. Patel (b) B R Ambedkar
(c) C Rajaji (d) S C Bose

36. Who was the first Indian to serve as Governor General?
(a) S C Bose (b) Maulana Azad
(c) Pandit Nehru (d) C Rajgopalchari

37. Which leader died fasting for a separate Telugu-speaking state?
(a) Maulana Azad (b) A C Rao
(c) T T Krishnamachari (d) Potti Sriramulu

38. In which sector is the establishment of Lalit Kala Akademi considered a major achievement post-independence?
(a) Scientific Development
(b) Cultural Heritage
(c) Economic Growth
(d) Educational Reforms

39. What was the old name of Madhya Pradesh?
(a) Bombay (b) United Province

(c) Central Province (d) Madras

40. What one of the following words refers to the Right to Vote?
(a) Citizenship (b) Suffrage
(c) Franchise (d) Both (b) and (c)

41. The slogan "Quit India" given by Mahatma Gandhi in 1942 was coined by?
(a) Yusuf Meherally (b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru (d) Subhas Chandra Bose

42. In which year was the state of Jharkhand formed?
(a) 2004 (b) 2001
(c) 1999 (d) 2000

43. In which year was ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) established?
(a) 1969 (b) 1966
(c) 1962 (d) 1959

44. In 1966, Punjab was divided into Punjab and which state?
(a) Rajasthan (b) Haryana
(c) Delhi (d) Kashmir

45. Jawaharlal Nehru modeled India's Five-Year Plans based on the system of which country?
(a) United States (b) United Kingdom
(c) Soviet Union (d) Germany

46. Through which state does the Mahanadi river flow?
(a) Odisha (b) Punjab
(c) Maharashtra (d) Rajasthan

47. Who led India's delegation to the United Nations between 1952 and 1962?
(a) Kanan Iyer (b) Krishna Menon
(c) Vijaylakshmi Pandit (d) Indira Gandhi

48. In which year did the First World War begin?
(a) 1912 (b) 1914
(c) 1915 (d) 1916

49. The Gandhi Sagar Dam is built on which river?
(a) Mahi (b) Ganga
(c) Chambal (d) Saraswati

50. Who became the first woman Chief Minister of independent India?
(a) Indira Gandhi (b) Vijaylakshmi Pandit
(c) Sucheta Kripalani (d) Aruna Asaf Ali

51. Who holds the position of Chairman in the Planning Commission?
(a) Finance Minister (b) Prime Minister
(c) President of India (d) Governor of RBI

52. At which station was India's first rocket launched in 1963?
(a) Sriharikota (b) Thumba
(c) Chandipur (d) Balasore

53. What was the old name of Sri Lanka?
(a) Ceylon (b) Burma
(c) Siam (d) East Pakistan

54. Who assassinated Mahatma Gandhi?
(a) Ganesh Mavlankar (b) Nathuram Godse
(c) Aga Khan (d) M A Jinnah

55. Which Prime Minister of India also served as the Foreign Minister?
(a) Lal Bahadur Shastri (b) Morarji Desai
(c) Indira Gandhi (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

56. Who led the Satyagraha for the formation of a separate Andhra state?
(a) Sarojini Naidu (b) Kasturba Gandhi
(c) Potti Sriramulu (d) C. Rajagopalachari

57. Which subject falls under the Concurrent List in India?
(a) Agriculture (b) Constitution
(c) Defence (d) Taxes

58. Who was India's first Foreign Minister after independence?
(a) Vijaylakshmi Pandit (b) Krishna Iyer
(c) Sardar Patel (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

59. After whom was the Secondary Education Commission of 1952-53 named?
(a) Radha Krishnan (b) Mudaliar
(c) Kothari (d) NPE

60. Which of the following statement are correct?
I. First President of India — Dr. Rajendra Prasad
II. First Prime Minister of India — Jawaharlal Nehru
III. First Education Minister of India — Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
IV. First Home Minister of India — Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
V. First Law Minister of India — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
(a) I, II and V (b) II, III and IV
(c) I, III and V (d) All of these

MCQ Answer

1-b	2-d	3-a	4-c	5-a
6-d	7-b	8-c	9-c	10-d
11-c	12-b	13-a	14-a	15-d
16-b	17-b	18-d	19-b	20-c
21-b	22-a	23-d	24-a	25-a
26-b	27-c	28-d	29-c	30-d
31-c	32-a	33-c	34-b	35-a
36-d	37-d	38-b	39-c	40-d
41-a	42-d	43-a	44-b	45-c
46-a	47-c	48-b	49-c	50-c
51-b	52-b	53-a	54-b	55-d
56-c	57-a	58-d	59-b	60-d